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The valuation U-turn bank investors missed

CURVE BALL. Large banks in low-growth developed economies trumped leaders in high-growth Indian economy**Nishanth Gopalakrishnan**
bl. research bureau

India, as the fastest growing major economy, has had the weakest performing large private banks. Large private lenders — HDFC Bank, Kotak Mahindra Bank and Axis Bank — have not only lost the race to PSU peers in terms of shareholder returns, but also to their global peers. These banks rank near the bottom in a comparison of returns delivered by some of the world's largest lenders since December 31, 2019 (the pre-pandemic cut-off). In contrast, the Sensex has gained 89 per cent over the same period.

Looking back, these lacklustre returns appear to stem more from a valuation problem than to do with fundamentals. Among the banks compared, only the Indian lenders have seen valuation multiples contract. Even ICICI Bank's 168 per cent gain is not an exception, having undergone a marginal de-rating. HDFC Bank's and Kotak Mahindra Bank's valuation multiples have halved, while Axis Bank's have fallen by 25 per cent.

The analysis underscores the importance of entry multiples even if the underlying business continues to perform well.

WHAT GIVES

Before the pandemic, the said banks were showing mid-teens to 20 per cent loan growth (FY17-20 CAGR) — far higher than the single-digit growth rates of global banks (readers should see this in the context of the growth rates of their underlying advanced economies). Their stocks were seen as prized possessions by investors.

On top of these, low global interest rates and high free float made the stocks favoured bets for FIIs in the pre-Covid era. Given India's expanding financial services market, investors expected these banks to sustain both strong growth and high return on equity (RoE) — a critical banking metric. Their December 2019 valuations reflected these expectations (see Table).

However, since the pandemic, despite solid loan growth, HDFC and Kotak have failed to sustain RoE. HDFC's earnings have grown

Low entry multiples and RoE improvement explain healthy gains

	Returns since Dec 31 2019 (%)	P/B on Dec 31 2019 (x)	Current P/B (x)	RoE in FY preceding Covid (%)*	RoE in latest concluded FY (%)**
MUFG (JPN)	486	0.5	1.8	3.9	11.3
SMFG (JPN)	399	0.5	1.6	7.6	10.4
Deutsche Bank (EU)	346	0.3	0.9	-9.5	9.3
UBS Group (EU)	248	0.8	1.8	7.9	8.8
Banco Santander (EU)	231	0.6	1.6	6.6	13.9
Barclays (UK)	188	0.6	1.1	4.6	9.9
ICICI Bank	168	3.0	2.7	8.1	16.0
HSBC Holdings (UK)	152	1.0	2.0	3.6	12.3
JPMorgan Chase (US)	145	1.8	2.6	15.0	17.0
BNP Paribas (EU)	93	0.7	0.9	8.1	9.6
Axis Bank	76	2.5	1.9	2.4	13.1
Bank of America (US)	74	1.3	1.6	10.6	10.6
Wells Fargo (US)	63	1.3	1.6	10.7	12.4
Citigroup (US)	62	1.0	1.1	10.3	6.8
HDFC Bank	29	4.3	2.1	16.5	13.7
Kotak Mahindra Bank	16	5.1	2.1	13.7	11.4

All figures pertain to consolidated financials

Cells shaded in green represent improvement in RoE

*FY20 (ended March 31) for Indian banks, MUFG and SMFG; CY19 for the rest

**FY26 for Indian banks, MUFG and SMFG; CY25 for the rest

Source: Company disclosures, Bloomberg

at a CAGR of 19 per cent in FY20-26 (includes benefit from the merger), while Kotak's earnings growth rate has fallen from 20 per cent to 14 per cent. Axis Bank's profits have improved to a CAGR of 56 per cent in FY20-

26 from -22 per cent in FY17-20 but concerns over its unsecured loans in recent years have weighed on its valuation. ICICI Bank, on the other hand, has reported higher earnings CAGR at 34 per cent (FY20-26) relative

to peers while more importantly, its RoE doubled to 16 per cent. Their high free float has now become a headwind. With global interest rates on the rise and AI trade heating up, FIIs have offloaded a chunk of their stake. FII holding in HDFC, ICICI, Axis and Kotak have come off peaks (since December 2019) of 52, 38, 53 and 45 per cent to 42, 35, 43 and 25 per cent now.

CONTRASTING TALE

The picture is markedly different among largest banks in each of the developed markets (the American, the British, Eurozone and Japanese banks considered for this analysis). Low entry valuations, combined with improving RoE, have translated into superior stock returns. Excluding JPMorgan Chase, the average price-to-book multiple of the foreign banks stood at just 0.8x as of December 2019, reflecting investor pessimism.

Post-pandemic, however, growth has improved meaningfully. JPMorgan Chase, Barclays, Deutsche Bank, UBS Group and MUFG have all reported stronger growth in loans, earnings and book value, leading to higher RoE.

INDIA IN A NEW ORBIT



PRIVATE BREAKTHROUGH. India marked a major milestone in its space journey on Saturday as Hyderabad-based Skyroot Aerospace successfully launched Vikram-1, the country's first privately developed orbital-class rocket, from Sriharikota. The Mission Agaman launch marks a significant step for India's private space sector. Vikram-1 is capable of carrying payloads of up to 350 kg to Low Earth Orbit (**Report on p14**). ANI

INVESTMENT.
FOCUS

Tech Call: Godrej Properties — Buy

Gurumurthy K
bl. research bureau

The long-term outlook is bullish for Godrej Properties (₹2,092). The strong rise from the low of ₹1,434 made in April marks the end of the downtrend that was in place since July 2024. This rise is also happening from a long-term trendline support. That strengthens the bullish case.

Supports are at ₹1,850 and ₹1,550. Godrej Properties share price can rally to ₹3,700 over the next one year.

Long-term investors can buy Godrej Properties shares now at ₹2,092. Accumulate on dips at ₹1,940. Keep the stop-loss at ₹1,420. Trail the stop-loss up to ₹2,420 when the price goes up to ₹2,730. Revise the stop-loss higher to ₹2,710 and ₹3,450 when the price touches ₹3,050 and ₹3,640, respectively. Exit at ₹3,700.

HDFC Bank CEO signals a push for growth; Q1 net profit up 5%

Our Bureau
Mumbai

HDFC Bank reported a 5 per cent year-on-year (YoY) rise in standalone net profit for the first quarter of FY27 at ₹19,060 crore, supported by higher net interest income and sharply lower provisions.

India's largest private sector bank had posted a net profit of ₹18,155 crore in the corresponding quarter last year.

Adjusted for transaction gains from the partial divestment in HDB Financial Services' IPO, certain provisions and a tax credit in the year-ago quarter, the Q1 net profit was about 10 per cent higher.

On the bank's growth outlook, Sashidhar Jagdishan, MD and CEO, said the investments made in distribution over the past five-six years would begin yielding benefits over the next couple of years.

“(On) advances, I think, we are on the cusp of pressing the pedal. Opportunities do exist, and there is a

Moderate show (in ₹ cr)

	Q1FY26	Q1FY27	y-o-y % change
Net profit	18,155	19,060	4.98
Net interest income	31,438	33,534	6.67
Operating profit	35,734	28,168	-21.17
Deposits	27,64,089	31,70,830	14.71
Advances	26,28,434	30,37,303	15.55
GNPA %	1.4	1.17	-
NNPA %	0.47	0.41	-

fair amount of buoyancy in what we are doing at this stage. The environment continues to be very healthy.”

FCNR (B) DEPOSITS

On mobilising fresh Foreign Currency Non-Resident (Bank) [FCNR (B)] deposits under the RBI's concessional swap facility, he said the Bank sees a significant opportunity.

Sashidhar said the Bank has already raised about \$750 million to provide leverage to NRIs for placing FCNR (B) deposits. It also plans to raise additional funds to extend its own leverage to its best customers.

Responding to a question on Sashidhar's reappointment for a third term, Deputy Managing Director Kaizad M Bharucha said: “The new chairman has just taken over. The GNRC (Governance, Nomination and Remuneration Committee) and the board is seized of the matter... As soon as they conclude (the process), we will come out and inform all of you people and the exchanges as to the outcome of the exercise.”

During the quarter, the net interest income (NII) rose 7 per cent to ₹33,534 crore, from ₹31,438 crore a year earlier. Provisions declined sharply by 79 per cent to ₹3,060 crore.

PNB Q1 net trebles on lower tax outgo, cost control

Our Bureau
New Delhi

With lower tax outgo and a check on operational expenses, Punjab National Bank's net profit more than trebled to an all-time quarterly high of over ₹5,200 crore during April-June period of 2026-27.

“On account of moving from old tax regime to new tax regime, we had to make a one-time provision of ₹3,200 crore during first quarter of last fiscal, which brought down the net profit during the said quarter to over ₹1,600 crore. However, since then the net profit has been around or over ₹5,000 crore and that momentum continued in the first quarter of cur-

Q1 scorecard (in ₹ cr)

	2025-26	2026-27	y-o-y % change
Interest income	31,964	32,897	2.9
Other income	5,268	4,333	-17.7
Total interest paid	21,386	22,099	3.3
Total expenses	30,150	29,712	-1.5
Provision for income tax	5,083	1,725	-66.1
Net profit	1,675	5,253	213.6

rent fiscal,” Ashok Chandra, MD and CEO, said in a virtual press conference. On a sequential basis, the growth in net profit was almost flat.

NIM IMPROVES

According to the bank, Net interest margin (NIM) from global business improved to 2.50 per cent in Q1 from 2.47 per cent. However, the net interest income (NII) grew

only 2.1 per cent to ₹10,798 crore but it was the highest in the last six quarters. Global business expanded by 10.2 per cent to ₹29.98-lakh crore.

The gross non-performing asset (GNPA) ratio improved by 100 bps to 2.78 per cent from 3.78 per cent. The net NPA ratio improved 10 bps to 0.28 per cent from 0.38 per cent. Provisions for the

quarter increased marginally on a sequential basis to ₹541 crore from ₹424 crore in the previous quarter.

Fresh slippage addition for the quarter stood at ₹2,080 crore, significantly below the ₹2,758 crore reported during the March quarter.

FCNR (B) DEPOSITS

Chandra said that as on date the bank has mobilised \$425 million through FCNR (B) deposits. “We hope to get around \$2.5 billion by September 30, 2026 (the due date for the liberalised scheme),” he said.

The bank has set a target of opening 250 branches during the current fiscal against 180 branches opened last fiscal.

Hamly Towers Grand Launch: Positioning Thanjavur as the New Gateway for GCCs in Tamil Nadu's Delta Region

Delta's First and Tallest Steel Structure IT Park in Thanjavur | A LEED Gold Certified Commercial Tower

HAMLY GROUP

An initiative led by Hamsavardhan Mohan, Founder & CEO, Hamly Group

THANJAVUR: Hamly Towers celebrated its Grand Launch on 18 July 2026, in the presence of Hon'ble Thiru J. Mohamed Farvace, Minister for Labour Welfare and Skill Development, Government of Tamil Nadu; Hon'ble Thiru R Vinoth, Minister for Agriculture and Farmers' Welfare, Government of Tamil Nadu; Thiru R. Vijayasaravanan, M.L.A. Member of the Legislative Assembly, Thanjavur Constituency, along with leading business executives, industry representatives and distinguished guests. The event also showcased Hamly Towers' commitment to supporting Thanjavur's transformation into a modern business destination. By offering Grade A commercial infrastructure, the project aims to attract leading enterprises, create quality employment, and strengthen the city's economic future.

Developed by BBS Infraspac, an enterprise of the Hamly Group, Hamly Towers was created to support the Tamil Nadu Delta's emergence as a destination for Global Capability Centres, IT, ITES, shared services and technology-led enterprises. Founded by Hamsavardhan Mohan, Hamly Group operates across healthcare Revenue Cycle Management, technology, commercial infrastructure, exports and community development. Its core business, Hamly Business Solutions, has grown from Thanjavur into an organisation employing more than 1,000 professionals and providing business support services to clients across global markets. Hamsavardhan Mohan began his entrepreneurial journey in 2016 from a 10x10 office. Hamly Towers reflects his larger vision of creating enterprise-ready infrastructure, attracting new business opportunities and enabling professionals to build meaningful careers closer to their hometowns.

The Delta's Emerging Business Opportunity: The Tamil Nadu Delta is emerging as a growing business and technology destination, supported by improving infrastructure, strong connectivity and a skilled talent pool from institutions across Thanjavur, Trichy, Kumbakonam and neighbouring districts. The region offers opportunities for IT, ITES, GCCs, BPO, healthcare RCM, finance, analytics and shared services, while also benefiting from reverse migration of experienced professionals from major metropolitan cities.

Why GCCs and Fortune 500 Companies Should Consider Hamly Towers: Hamly Towers provides enterprise-ready office space with access to the Delta's growing talent ecosystem while offering significantly lower occupancy and operating costs than major metropolitan cities. Designed for GCCs, branch offices and delivery centres, the project features centralized HVAC, high-speed elevators, 24/7 power backup and modern building management systems. With connectivity to major highways, rail networks and Tiruchirappalli International Airport, Hamly Towers is well suited for IT, ITES, BPO, KPO, RCM, SaaS, finance and shared service operations



Grand Launch at Hamly Towers, July 18, 2026, attended by Tamil Nadu Ministers.

seeking long-term scalability from an emerging business destination.

LEED Advantage for Occupying Companies: Hamly Towers has been developed in accordance with the internationally recognised LEED framework of the U.S. Green Building Council, with a focus on energy efficiency, responsible resource management and indoor environmental quality. This provides companies with improved workplace comfort, reduced energy consumption, support for ESG goals, and alignment with the global sustainability standards followed by GCCs and multinational companies.

Project Facts:

- LEED Gold Certified
- Enterprise Ready Offices
- 4,000+ Workforce Capacity
- 49,515 sq.ft. Leasable Space
- Near Tiruchirappalli International Airport
- Lower Operating Costs than Metro Cities
- Strong Talent Pool Across the Delta Region
- G+6 Floors with 9,903 sq.ft. per Floor



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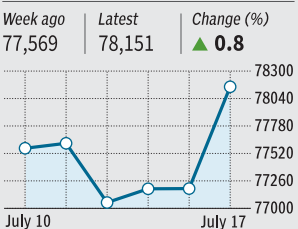
WISE WORDS.

“ Since humans love to gamble so much, there’s more money in actually cultivating gamblers than there are (in) cultivating investors

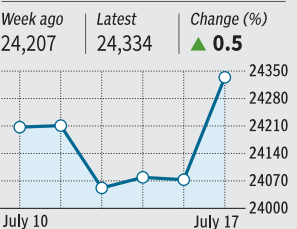
WARREN BUFFETT

MARKET ACTION.

SENSEX



NIFTY



Time is ticking for oil reserves

BUFFER WATCH. The market absorbed the first Hormuz disruption by drawing down inventories and tapping spare capacity. Those stockpiles are now thinner, leaving crude prices more vulnerable to another supply shock



Akhil Nallamuthu
bl. research bureau

Geopolitical risk, the familiar catalyst, is sending crude oil prices higher, again. The peace agreement between the US and Iran, which was already regarded as a fragile one, came under the biggest strain yet on July 7, as both countries traded fresh rounds of attacks.

Till then, it appeared like the crude bears had cleanly bowled out the bulls. Their confidence that the surge in Dated Brent prices was temporary was reflected in the steep backwardation curve of Brent futures.

However, now, with Hormuz disruption back in play, and crude prices on the rise again, it appears this time it’s different. The price behaviour within the crude complex is not the same as the earlier rally.

When the Strait of Hormuz was closed in early March, as an initial reaction, Dated Brent, the one representing the physical crude oil prices for immediate delivery, surged 45 per cent, outperforming the Brent futures’ 36 per cent rise in the first ten days of the conflict. But since the recent escalation, so far, Brent futures has rallied 22 per cent, marginally outperforming Dated Brent, up 21 per cent.

Interestingly though, one important factor remained at elevated levels and never cooled: Crack spread, which is the price difference between a barrel of raw crude oil and refined products made from it like gasoline, diesel etc. Even when the prices of both Dated Brent and Brent futures fell, post the signing of a Memorandum of Understanding between the US and Iran on June 18, the crack spread did not correct much. In fact, post the re-escalation now, it surpassed the peak of \$59.77/barrel it had hit early during the war and marked a fresh all-time high of \$69.16/barrel on July 15.

Why has the crack spread stayed higher? What does the price behaviour of Dated Brent and Brent futures signal? What do both mean for the prices? Here’s an analysis.

THE BOTTLENECK

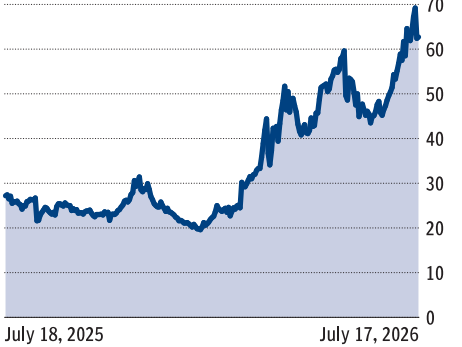
The 3-2-1 crack spread, a widely-used proxy for refinery gross margin, measures the difference between the value of refined products and the cost of crude oil. It assumes that three barrels of crude yield two barrels of gasoline and one barrel of distillate such as diesel, jet fuel or heating oil. The process of refining is also referred to as cracking, hence the name.

Unlike Brent futures and Dated Brent, the crack spread witnessed only a modest correction after the announcement of the US-Iran peace deal in June. While the spread declined 28 per cent from its peak, both Brent futures and Dated Brent slumped to a low in early July, losing by 41 per cent and 53 per cent respectively.

The latest escalation pushed the spread to a record high of \$69.16/barrel on July 15. This comes even as crude oil prices are nowhere near the

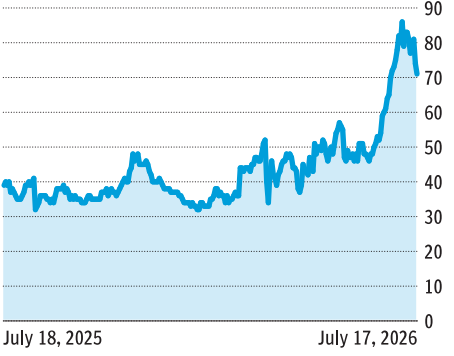
Tight fuel markets lift crack spreads

3-2-1 crack spread (\$/barrel)



Refining margin nears crude costs

Crack spread as % of Brent futures



wartime record-highs despite the recent rally. As a per cent of Brent futures, the crack spread increased from 46 per cent to a substantial 86 per cent on July 6. It stands at 71 per cent now.

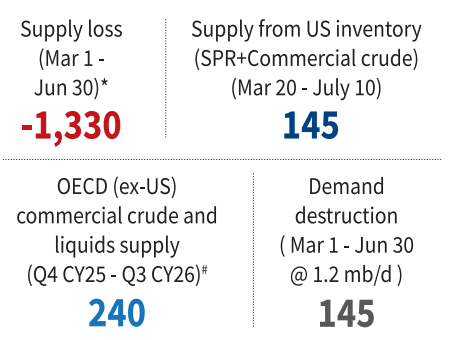
The divergence suggests that refined-product markets are considerably tighter than the crude market. More importantly, the tightness appears to be driven more by supply constraints rather than a surge in demand.

Part of the explanation lies in inventories. According to the US Energy Information Administration (EIA), for the week ended July 3, distillate inventories were 12 per cent below the five-year average, while gasoline inventories were 6 per cent below the average.

Gasoline inventories were lower due to a combination of factors such as lower production, lower imports and higher exports. At the same time, refiners appear to have prioritised distillates as margins remained significantly stronger. The refining gross margin for distillate (also referred as distillate crack) currently stands at about \$84/barrel compared to gasoline crack of \$52/barrel.

How supply losses were offset

Volume (million barrels)



*cumulative figure; still rising as Hormuz remains shut
estimate; mb/d: million barrels/day
Source: EIA, IEA

The preference for distillates has coincided with disruptions to Russian refining operations. Ukraine’s attacks have affected more than a quarter of Russia’s refining capacity, and the refinery runs have slumped to a two-decade low. This curtailed supplies of diesel and other refined products as well. Russia has also imposed a temporary ban on diesel exports until July 31 and also restrictions on sales of gasoline and jet fuel.

Longer shipping routes following the disruption of traditional trade flows have added to distillate consumption, further tightening balances. So, broadly, the bottleneck appeared to have shifted from crude oil supplies to refined product supplies. Consequently, refining margins have continued to strengthen even after the crude market shed much of its geopolitical risk premium. However, the recent re-escalation can complicate things.

Factoring in the above, the latest rally in crude oil prices appears to be driven more by precautionary risk premium than by signs of immediate physical shortage.

FEAR BUT NOT FRENZY

After the US attacked Iran for the first time in February, crude oil prices surged. Dated Brent, the benchmark for physical cargoes, rallied 104 per cent to hit a high of \$144.46/barrel on April 7, while Brent futures gained 64 per cent to touch \$119.50/barrel on March 9. Notably, futures peaked nearly a month before the physical benchmark.

The divergence reflected the scramble for prompt barrels — oil available immediately. Brent futures, on the other hand, quote oil for delivery at a future date.

With the Strait of Hormuz shut and uncertainty surrounding replacement supplies, buyers were willing to pay steep premiums for cargoes that were already available. Consequently, Dated Brent’s premium over Brent futures widened to a record \$35.87/barrel on April 9.

Backwardation inching up again

Sept 2026 Vs Jun 2027 Brent futures spread (\$/barrel)



The same message was visible in the futures curve. Near-term contracts significantly outperformed deferred contracts, pushing the market into steep backwardation.

Futures curve in backwardation means near-term oil contracts trade at a premium to the longer-dated ones. The spread between the front-month (September 2026) and the June 2027 Brent futures contract widened to a record \$42.99/barrel on March 9.

The latest escalation has produced a different response. Since July 7, Brent futures have risen 22 per cent, whereas Dated Brent is up 21 per cent. The spread between September 2026 and June 2027 contracts has also recovered only modestly to about \$10/barrel, well below the levels seen during the peak of the Hormuz disruption.

The difference is because, earlier, prices were anchored by a genuine shortage of immediately-available barrels. Today, prices appear to be anchored more by expectations than by physical scarcity.

That said, the current calm in the physical market is contingent on oil continuing to flow. And there lies the real risk.

Physical tightness has eased but requires monitoring

Dated Brent premium over Brent futures (\$/barrel)



THINNER CUSHION

The last time the Strait of Hormuz was shut, the oil market had a cushion. This time, that appears considerably thinner.

What changed in the oil market

Metric	Then (first Hormuz closure)	Now
US total inventories	872 mb	726 mb
US Strategic Petroleum Reserves	415 mb	316 mb
Distillate inventories	120 mb	108 mb
Gasoline inventories	241 mb	211 mb
OECD (ex-US) inventories	1,543 mb	1,303 mb*
OPEC spare capacity	3.43 mb/d	0.44 mb/d
Russian refinery throughput	5.4 mb/d	3.8 mb/d

*Q3 CY26 forecast; mb: million barrels; mb/d: million barrels/day
Note: Usable inventories can be much lower than the numbers suggest due to operational constraints. Source: EIA, Bloomberg/EA Analytics

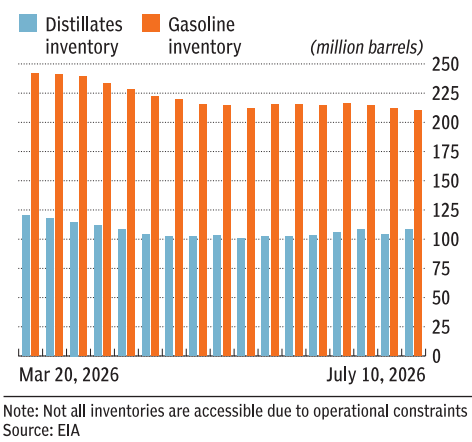
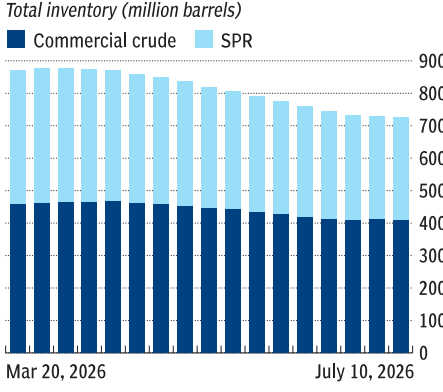
Following the June 18 peace deal between the US and Iran, the US EIA lowered its Brent crude forecast for 2026 to \$82/barrel from \$95/barrel earlier and projected prices to average \$65/barrel in 2027. But the outlook was based on the assumption that oil would continue flowing through Hormuz.

The first disruption was absorbed through a combination of factors such as inventories, strategic reserves, rerouted trade flows and weaker demand. EIA’s Short-Term Energy Outlook (STEO) projects OECD commercial crude and liquids inventories (ex-US) to decline from 1,543 million barrels at the end of 2025 to 1,303 million barrels by the third quarter of 2026, a drawdown of 240 million barrels.

Moreover, EIA recently noted that inventories at Cushing, Oklahoma, have approached levels near the “tank bottoms”. Since storage facilities require a minimum volume of oil to remain operational, not every barrel reported in inventories is necessarily available to the market.

The total inventory in the US, that includes Strategic Petroleum Reserves (SPR) and commercial stocks, is already down by 145 million barrels to 726 million barrels between March 20,

US oil buffers continue to drop



Note: Not all inventories are accessible due to operational constraints
Source: EIA

when SPR access began, and July 10. SPR dropped by 99 million barrels to 316 million barrels, whereas commercial stocks decreased by about 47 million to 410 million barrels.

Global oil consumption is estimated to decline by 1.2 million barrels/day this year, largely because of weaker demand in Asia. The slowdown in demand was another factor that helped absorb the first disruption.

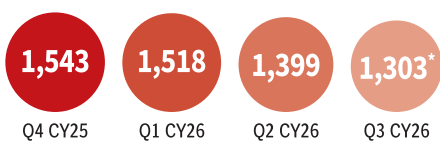
At the same time, spare production capacity has shrunk sharply. The EIA estimates OPEC’s surplus production capacity at just 0.44 million barrels/day in 2026, down from 3.43 million barrels/day in 2025. Notably, spare capacity in West Asia is estimated at zero from the second quarter through the rest of this year.

The EIA had expected inventories to begin rebuilding from the fourth quarter and spare capacity to recover in 2027. Instead, the market now faces another disruption.

The strain is already visible in fuel markets. According to the IEA (International Energy

Global oil cushion shrinks

OECD (ex-US) inventory (million barrels)



*forecast
Note: Not all inventories are accessible due to operational constraints
Source: EIA

Agency), global refinery throughput in June was about 6 million barrels/day lower than a year ago as West Asian export refineries remained disrupted, Russian refinery runs were curtailed and several Asian plants continued to operate below normal levels. Russian refinery output alone was about 1.6 million barrels/day lower than last year.

Recently, the IEA warned that the global economy has only a matter of weeks and not months before a prolonged disruption through Hormuz begins to cause broader economic damage.

STAKES ARE HIGH

In our Big Story, *The 900-million-barrel question in bl.portfolio* edition dated May 10, we had noted how from March 1 till then, cumulatively around 900-million barrels in crude oil supply was lost and that a quick full opening of the Strait of Hormuz was essential to prevent flare-ups in oil prices. Release from strategic reserves by many countries, lower imports by China, higher exports by the US and modest demand destruction had saved the day back then.

This time, it’s different. The latest escalation comes at a time when many of those buffers have weakened. OECD commercial crude and liquids inventories, a widely-followed proxy for global oil stockpiles, are projected to be down by 240 million barrels from 2025-end levels. In the US, the combined SPR and commercial inventories have already fallen by 145 million barrels since March 20. OPEC’s spare production capacity has also shrunk to 0.44 million barrels/day in 2026 from 3.43 million barrels/day in 2025, while refined-product markets remain exceptionally tight, as reflected in the record-high crack spread.

The risks are widening. Iran has threatened disruption through the Bab-el-Mandeb Strait, another critical shipping route, while any recovery in Chinese crude imports could tighten balances further. For now, the market appears to be pricing a risk premium rather than an outright shortage. But if these risks materialise simultaneously, today’s premium could evolve into genuine physical scarcity. In this scenario, oil prices may not just revisit their earlier peak of \$119.50/barrel, they could overshoot it sharply.

Based on technical analysis, crude oil prices could hit \$115. For details, check p8



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The simple and complex of I-T

DE-TAX. The two most-used income-tax forms reflect a quiet shift — ITR-1 got easier, while ITR-2 has become harder

Desikan Govindarajan

The income-tax return filing season for FY26 or AY27 is drawing to a close with barely a couple of weeks left for the July 31 deadline. In recent years, for individual assesseees without business income, the tax filing process had become incredibly simple or little more complex, depending on which form the returns are filed.

Consider this: Assessee A, a Bengaluru-based software engineer, wrapped up filing his tax returns in 27 minutes in April. Three years ago, the same exercise took him three hours and a call to his brother-in-law, who is a chartered accountant. His income has not changed — a salary, some mutual fund gains and a home loan. The form (ITR-1) has!

His experience reflects a quiet shift. India's two most-used income-tax forms, ITR-1 (Sahaj) and ITR-2, have been re-drafted, re-scoped and re-populated across three assessment years (AY24-26). The straightforward filer moves faster and lighter. The complex filer faces sharper questions.

WHAT GOT EASIER

ITR-1 accounts for over half of the returns filed in the country — at 5.25 crore in FY25 on a base of nine crore returns. It is the simplest of the forms that is applicable when a taxpayer's income source is limited to salary/pension, one house property, interest/dividend income from securities and other investments. Four moves by the income-tax department have further simplified the form.

The taxman relaxed the ITR-1 eligibility gate for AY26. Salaried filers, with long-term capital gains up to ₹1.25 lakh on listed equity — the annual Section 112A exemption, can now file ITR-1, provided there are no brought-forward or carry-forward capital losses. Any capital gain, however small, previously forced the taxpayer into the heavier ITR-2. For FY26 filers,

The tax form evolution

Three years of redesign have split India's tax base into two tracks

Tax season AY23-26

ITR-1 (SAHAJ) - EASIER

- Section 112A LTCG up to ₹1.25 lakh now allowed
- AIS/TIS pre-fill covers most heads
- Discard return facility available
- Refunds credited in

Filing time: 20-30 minutes

ITR-2 - HEAVIER

- **Schedule FA:** ESOPs, foreign accounts/ Mfs
- **Schedule VDA:** line-by-line crypto reporting
- **Schedule AL:** assets, liabilities reporting when income > ₹50 lakh

often requires a CA

Simple filers move faster and lighter. Complex filers meet sharper questions

● EASE OF FILING

The direction of change reflects a clear intent to reduce the effort involved in filing for the vast majority of taxpayers

not liable for tax audit), giving different stakeholder groups room to prepare and file, avoiding a single-day rush.

The Finance Act 2024 rewrote the capital gains framework — 12.5 per cent on long-term, 20 per cent on short-term listed equities — with effect from July 23, 2024. About one-third of FY25 fell before that date; the rest after.

Schedule CG in ITR-2 for AY26 (relevant for FY25), therefore, split the year into two rate-regimes and taxpayers can recall this added complication for AY26.

However, this split-reporting does not continue into AY27, making even the ITR-2 lighter in this aspect, relative to AY26.

WHAT GOT TOUGHER

If ITR-1 has become simpler in the last three years, ITR-2 has grown in scope.

Schedule FA (Foreign Assets) has expanded. ESOP grants from parent companies listed abroad, foreign bank accounts and offshore mutual funds — all trigger disclosure in ITR-2. The Black Money Act, 2015, sits behind the Schedule and the penal consequences of non-compliance are severe: A flat 30 per cent tax on undisclosed foreign income and assets, a penalty of ₹10 lakh for each year of default on disclosure, and prosecution with imprisonment ranging from six months to seven years for wilful default. India's workforce, employed by foreign companies/MNCs, earning ESOPs and other individuals invested in foreign-listed shares face this issue every year.

Schedule VDA (Virtual Digital Assets) is now three years old and has quietly become heavier. The taxpayer must disclose every crypto transaction

line by line and the gains are taxable at 30 per cent. Losses under other heads of income are not eligible to be offset against VDA gains, nor are VDA losses eligible to be offset against income under other heads. VDA losses also cannot be carried forward to subsequent years.

Schedule AL — Assets and Liabilities (requires an assessee to declare assets and liabilities) — kicks in above ₹50 lakh of income; the threshold has not been changed since 2018. Career growth and salary inflation have likely pushed many senior professionals into this reporting bracket for the first time.

Further for AY27, the CBDT removed Section 89A-reporting from ITR-1: A filer with income from an overseas retirement benefit account must now use ITR-2.

SUMMING UP

The direction of change reflects a clear intent to reduce the effort involved in filing for the vast majority of taxpayers. Pre-fill from Form 26AS and the AIS cuts data entry time; the discard-return facility offers filers a second chance; refunds arrive faster.

Additional reporting appears only where the underlying tax policy demands it — foreign assets, multi-property income, dabbling in crypto. For the salaried employee with a clean Form 16, the changes of recent years have made the filing exercise quite easy and the portal is simplified for them.

For returns with more moving parts — the ITR-2, for instance — engaging a professional, whose expertise matches the added complexity, remains the prudent choice and helps the assessee complete the process with confidence. Readers can also refer to our earlier article (<https://tinyurl.com/2sh3efm9>), which can help decide whether it would make sense to seek professional advice in your case.

The author is a Partner at Venkatesh and Co, chartered accountants. With inputs from Hrishikesh D and Manikarnika B

Interest rates on home loans (%)

Institution	Loan amount		
	Under ₹30 lakh	₹30 to 75 lakh	Over ₹75 lakh
BANKS (Floating rates)			
Axis Bank	8.0-9.10	8.0-9.10	8.0-9.10
Bank of Baroda	7.20-8.95	7.20-8.95	7.20-8.95
Bank of India	7.10-10	7.10-10	7.10-10
Bank of Maharashtra	7.10-9.65	7.10-9.65	7.10-9.65
Canara Bank	7.15-10	7.10-10	7.05-9.9
Central Bank	7.10-8.75	7.10-8.75	7.10-8.75
DBS Bank	<=8.70	<=8.70	<=8.70
Dhanlaxmi Bank	>=7.65	>=7.65	>=7.65
Federal Bank	7.35-9.25	7.35-9.25	7.35-9.25
HDFC Bank	7.75-13.20	7.75-13.20	7.75-13.20
ICICI Bank	>=7.55	>=7.55	>=7.55
Indian Bank	7.15-8.55	7.15-8.55	7.15-8.55
IOB	7.20-8.30	7.20-8.30	7.20-8.30
IDBI Bank	7.40-11.90	7.40-11.90	7.40-11.90
J&K Bank	>= 7.25	>= 7.25	>= 7.25
Karnataka Bank	7.49-11.72	7.49-11.72	7.49-11.72
Karur Vysya Bank	8.50-10.65	8.50-10.65	8.50-10.65
Kotak Mahindra Bank	>=7.60	>=7.60	>=7.60
Punjab National Bank	7.25-9.10	7.20-9.10	7.20-9.10
Punjab & Sind Bank	7.30-10.70	7.30-10.70	7.30-10.70
RBL Bank	>= 9.0	>= 9.0	>= 9.0
State Bank of India	7.25-8.55	7.25-8.55	7.25-8.55
South Indian Bank	>=7.20	>=7.20	>=7.20
Tamilnad Mercantile Bank	7.90-9.30	7.90-9.30	7.90-9.30
BANKS (Fixed rates)			
Bank of Baroda	8.90-9.95	8.90-9.95	8.90-9.95
Canara Bank	8.50-10.75	8.50-10.75	8.50-10.75
Punjab National Bank	8.25-10.60	8.20-10.60	8.20-10.50
HOUSING FINANCE COMPANIES (Floating rates)			
Tata Capital	>=7.50	>=7.50	>=7.50
PNB Housing	7.75-10.05	7.60-10.05	7.50-9.95
Central Bank Housing	10-12.85	10-12.85	10-12.35
Samman Capital	>=8.75	>=8.75	>=8.75
Aditya Birla Housing Fin	>=7.75	>=7.75	>=7.75
Bajaj Finserv	7.25-20	7.25-20	7.25-20
GIC Housing Finance	>=8.80	>=8.80	>=8.80
Sundaram Home Finance *	>=10.65	>=10.65	>=10.65
Piramal Finance Limited	>=9.99	>=9.99	>=9.99
IIFL Home Finance	>=8.75	>=8.75	>=8.75
LIC Housing Finance	7.15-9.65	7.15-9.75	7.15-10.10
HOUSING FINANCE COMPANIES (Fixed rates)			
LIC Housing Finance	10-10.25	10-10.25	10-10.25

Rates that vary with tenures or credit score within the specified loan amounts are indicated as a range. Fixed interest rates may be subject to a revision after a specified tenure. Rates may also apply only for a definite period and change to floating thereafter. Data taken from respective bank's website as on Jul 17, 2026. Contributed by BankBazaar.com, an online marketplace for comparing loans and insurance products. *Annual percentage rate;

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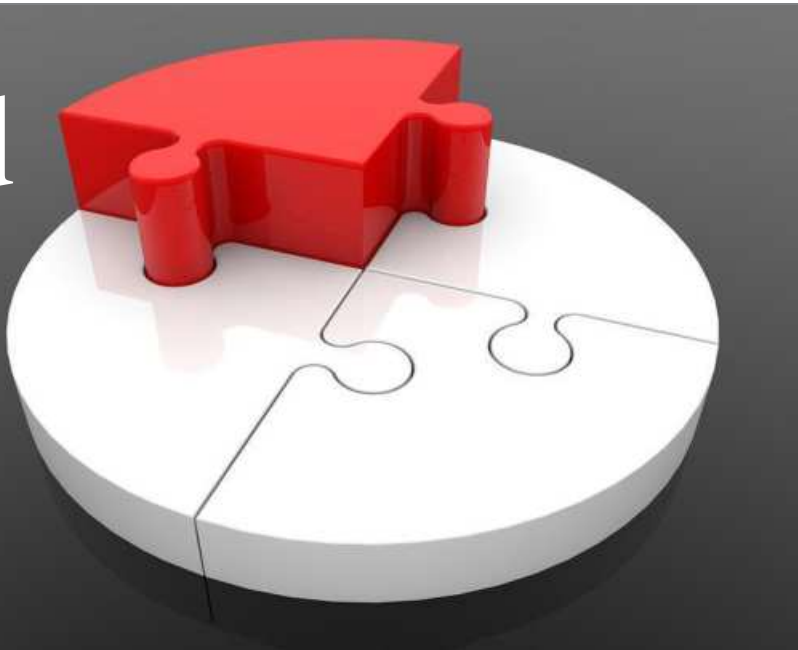
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Building a hybrid portfolio, one piece at a time

FUND CALL. ICICI Pru Regular Savings is suitable for investors with a low- to moderate-risk appetite



GETTY IMAGES/STOCKPHOTO

Dhuraivel Gunasekaran
bl. research bureau

ICICI Prudential Regular Savings Fund, a conservative hybrid fund, has consistently outperformed its peers by generating debt-plus returns over the years. Its strategy of combining a large-cap-oriented equity portfolio with a high-yield debt portfolio has enabled it to earn superior risk-adjusted returns.

Over the past 10 years, the fund has posted a compounded annual growth rate (CAGR) of 9 per cent, comfortably ahead of the category average of 7.3 per cent.

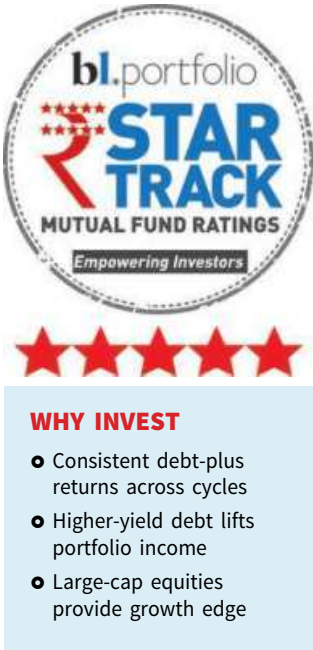
Conservative hybrid funds are meant for low- to moderate-risk investors seeking limited equity exposure. These funds typically invest 75-90 per cent of their corpus in debt and 10-25 per cent in equities. The debt allocation provides stability and regular income, while equities add a growth kicker.

The fund has maintained an equity allocation of 15-24 per cent over the past five years, adjusting it in line with market conditions, while the balance has been invested in debt instruments.

EQUITY STRATEGY

The fund follows a blend of top-down and bottom-up investing. It first identifies sectors likely to benefit from the prevailing economic and business cycle. For instance, during economic slowdowns, the portfolio is tilted towards defensive and resilient businesses. Within these preferred sectors, the fund selects fundamentally-strong companies with attractive valuations.

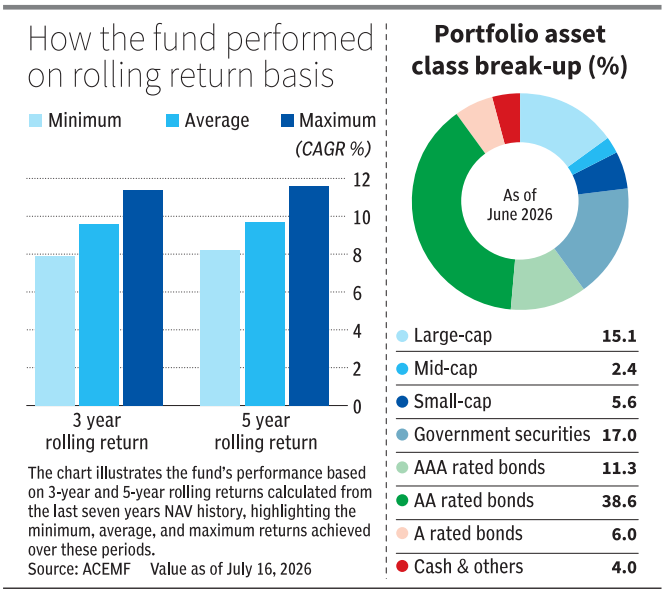
Portfolio construction follows a disciplined framework



that combines sector attractiveness with stock-specific opportunities. The largest allocation is made to companies where both the sector outlook and stock fundamentals are favourable. Smaller allocations are made to attractive sectors with selective opportunities or to strong companies in weaker sectors with long-term growth potential. The fund avoids sectors and stocks where both the outlook and fundamentals are weak.

It also follows a contrarian approach, looking for stocks that are temporarily out of favour but have limited downside and meaningful long-term upside. Stock selection is backed by detailed valuation analysis to ensure a margin of safety rather than chasing momentum.

The fund is currently overweight in large private banks, life insurers, select IT, chemicals and pharma stocks. It stays un-



derweight in capital market-linked businesses, industrials, consumer discretionary and e-commerce companies.

As per the latest portfolio, the top three sector exposures were banks, insurance and automobiles. Over the last year, the fund increased exposure to retailing, food products and banks while trimming exposure to pharma, oil and cement products.

In terms of market-cap bias, nearly two-thirds of the equity allocation is invested in large-caps, with the balance in mid- and small-caps. Currently, around 13 per cent of the total assets are invested in large-caps, 3 per cent in mid-caps and 6 per cent in small-caps.

DEBT STRATEGY

On the debt side, the fund follows an actively-managed strategy with a flexible mandate. The portfolio comprises government securities, high-quality corporate bonds, PSU debt and

select private corporate bonds up to the single-A rating. The portfolio duration has been kept moderate, with a Macaulay duration of 1.25-3.5 years over the past five years.

As of the latest portfolio, government securities accounted for 17 per cent of the corpus, while corporate debt accounted for 52 per cent, pass-through certificates 3 per cent and certificates of deposit 2 per cent.

A distinguishing feature of the fund is its meaningful exposure to non-AAA-rated debt, which typically ranges between 30 per cent and 50 per cent of the portfolio. It is among the few conservative hybrid funds with sizeable allocations to this segment, alongside Nippon India Conservative Hybrid, SBI Conservative Hybrid and Aditya Birla Sun Life Regular Savings. In the latest portfolio, AAA-rated securities accounted for 11 per cent, AA-rated papers 39 per cent and single-A securities 6 per cent.

The fund generally limits the maturity of its non-AAA holdings to two-three years to contain credit risk. Key issuers in this segment include Prism Johnson, Kogta Financial (India), Ashiana Housing and Hir-anandani Financial Services.

The debt portfolio's yield to maturity (YTM) stood at 8 per cent, compared to category average of 7.2 per cent.

SUPERIOR PERFORMANCE

ICICI Prudential Regular Savings Fund has consistently exhibited superior risk-adjusted returns across most equity and interest rate cycles.

An analysis of five-year rolling returns over the last seven years shows that the fund generated an average annualised return of 9.7 per cent, outperforming the category average of 8.7 per cent. Its five-year rolling returns ranged from a minimum of 8.2 per cent to a maximum of 11.6 per cent.

On a three-year rolling basis, the fund delivered an average CAGR of 9.6 per cent, compared with the category average of 8.8 per cent.

Its base expense ratio for the regular plan is 1.42 per cent, marginally below the category average of 1.44 per cent. The direct plan's expense ratio stands at 0.8 per cent, compared with the category average of 0.75 per cent.

The fund aims to generate returns superior to traditional debt investments while limiting downside risk through a predominantly debt-oriented portfolio.

It may be suitable for investors with a low- to moderate-risk appetite seeking modest equity exposure over a medium-term investment horizon.

Inside the latest MF ratings

UPDATE ALERT. The *bl.portfolio* Star Track Mutual Fund Ratings assessed 488 schemes across 32 fund categories

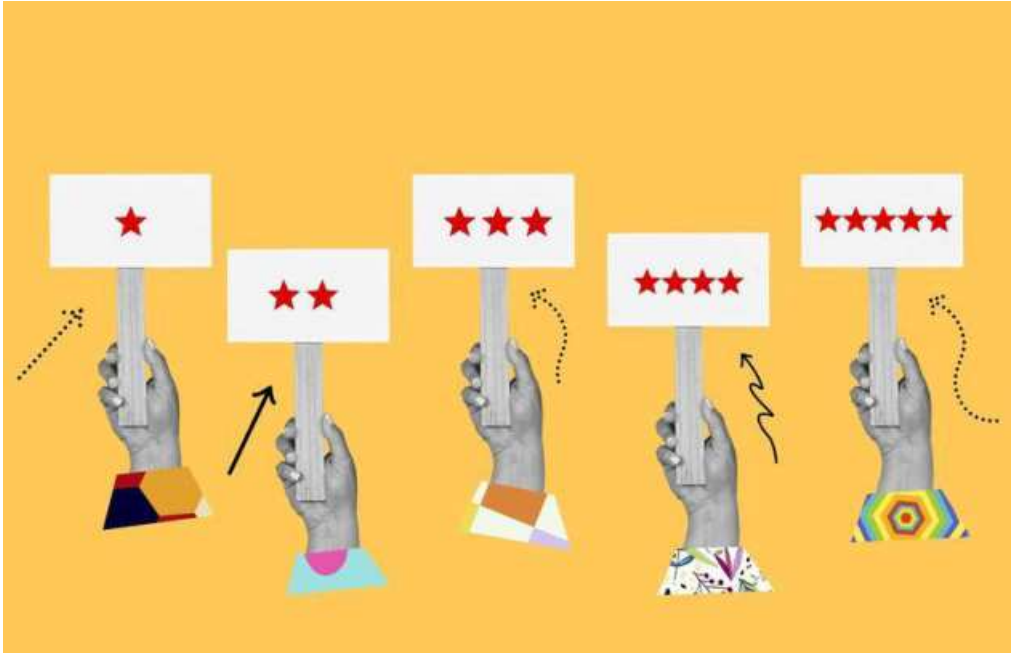
Dhuraivel Gunasekaran
bl. research bureau

Choosing the right mutual fund from a universe of over 1,900 schemes is no easy task. While short-term returns often dominate investors' attention, sustained performance across market cycles is a better indicator of a fund's quality. The *bl.portfolio* Star Track Mutual Fund Ratings seek to simplify this exercise by identifying funds that have consistently delivered superior risk-adjusted returns within their respective categories.

Launched in October 2018, the *bl.portfolio* Star Track Mutual Fund Ratings are updated twice a year using data as of June-end and December-end. The latest edition, based on data as of June 30, 2026, evaluates 488 schemes across 32 actively managed mutual fund categories. The ratings shortlist these schemes from a universe of 1,945 mutual fund schemes spanning 39 categories and asset classes, providing investors with a structured framework to compare funds and build long-term portfolios.

The rating framework is based on two key measures: rolling returns and the Sortino ratio. Together, they help identify funds that have delivered consistent returns while keeping downside risk under control. While rolling returns measure a fund's performance across different market periods, the Sortino ratio evaluates how efficiently those returns have been generated by considering only downside volatility.

For equity and hybrid funds, the ratings are based on one-, three- and five-year rolling returns using seven years of NAV history. Debt funds are assessed using one-, two- and three-year rolling returns over the past five years. In addition, one-year trailing returns are included to reflect recent performance. The final score gives a 60 per cent weight to rolling returns, 30 per cent to the Sortino



INVEST RIGHT
Use the ratings as a starting point, but select funds based on your asset allocation, risk appetite and investment horizon

ratio and 10 per cent to trailing returns. Based on these scores, funds are assigned star ratings from one to five (lowest to highest), making it easier for investors to identify relatively better-performing schemes within each category. Funds are assigned star ratings based on percentile rankings: top 10 percentile (five-star), next 20 percentile (four-star), middle 40 percentile (three-star), next 20 percentile (two-star), and bottom 10 percentile (one-star).

SUMMARY OF THE UPDATE

The latest edition, based on data as of June 30, 2026, rates 488 actively managed mutual fund schemes across 32 equity, hybrid and debt fund categories. A new

addition this time is the multi-asset allocation fund category, which has become eligible for evaluation as at least five schemes now have a comparable seven-year track record. For this category, only funds that maintained an allocation of more than 65 per cent to equity and equity-related instruments over the past seven years have been considered, ensuring a like-for-like comparison.

UPGRADES

Fund quality remained largely stable in the latest review, with 45 schemes retaining their five-star ratings between December 2025 and June 2026, reflecting sustained performance across market cycles.

Among equity funds, schemes such as Nippon India Large Cap, ICICI Prudential Large Cap, Quant Mid Cap, Edelweiss Mid Cap, Quant Small Cap, Parag Parikh Flexi Cap, HDFC Flexi Cap and JM Flexicap Fund continued to hold the highest rating. In the hybrid segment, funds such as Quant Aggressive Hybrid, Bank of India Mid & Small Cap Equity &

Debt, ICICI Prudential Equity & Debt, HDFC Balanced Advantage and Baroda BNP Paribas Balanced Advantage Fund retained their five-star status. In debt funds, schemes such as UTI Banking & PSU, ICICI Prudential Banking & PSU Debt, ICICI Prudential Corporate Bond, Nippon India Corporate Bond, UTI Dynamic Bond, ICICI Prudential Gilt and SBI Gilt Fund remained among the top-rated schemes.

The latest review also saw several funds move into the top tier. Nine schemes were upgraded from four stars to five, while five funds jumped directly from three stars to five. Notable upgrades from four to five stars include Quant Large & Mid Cap, Nippon India Growth Mid Cap, Bank of India Small Cap, SBI Conservative Hybrid and Aditya Birla Sun Life Dynamic Bond Fund. Funds making a two-notch leap from three to five stars include Invesco India Largecap, Tata India Consumer, Motilal Oswal ELSS Tax Saver, SBI Healthcare Opportunities and HSBC Equity Savings Fund.

A further 21 schemes improved

from three to four stars. These include HSBC Flexi Cap, Aditya Birla Sun Life Flexi Cap, Invesco India Large & Mid Cap, Baroda BNP Paribas Large Cap, Union Small Cap, Bandhan Aggressive Hybrid, Bandhan Banking & PSU Debt, Aditya Birla Sun Life Banking & PSU Debt, SBI Floating Rate Debt, Bandhan Gilt and Baroda BNP Paribas Gilt Fund.

DOWNGRADES

Not all funds managed to sustain their earlier ratings. Thirteen schemes slipped from five stars to four, including HDFC Large & Mid Cap, Canara Robeco Large Cap, HDFC Mid Cap, Nippon India Small Cap, ICICI Prudential Pharma Healthcare & Diagnostics, SBI Technology Opportunities, Kotak Debt Hybrid, Sundaram Equity Savings, 360 ONE Dynamic Bond and Nippon India Ultra Short Duration Fund.

Another 25 schemes fell from four stars to three. These include Union Flexi Cap, PGIM India Flexi Cap, SBI Large & Midcap, HDFC Large Cap, Kotak Large Cap, Axis Small Cap, Baroda BNP Paribas Aggressive Hybrid, HDFC Equity Savings, Axis Banking & PSU Debt, Franklin India Banking & PSU Debt, ICICI Prudential Floating Interest and DSP Gilt Fund.

PRUDENT PLAY

The ratings are intended to help investors identify funds that have consistently delivered superior risk-adjusted returns over the long term. While the ratings can serve as a useful starting point for fund selection, investors should choose schemes that align with their asset allocation, risk appetite and investment horizon. Preference can be given to four- and five-star funds. A brief spell of underperformance should not be a reason to exit if a fund continues to enjoy a strong rating. However, funds that consistently slip to two stars or below deserve a closer review and may be considered for replacement.

ALERTS.

MF transmission process further streamlined

The Association of Mutual Funds in India (AMFI) has announced modifications to its procedure to claim units/proceeds upon death of a unit holder, aimed at simplifying the mutual fund transmission process. In cases where there is a mismatch in the recorded address of the deceased unit holder, Asset Management Companies (AMCs) are now advised to rely on the latest available address details, provided they are supported by relevant documents. To tackle discrepancies in the name or signature of the unit holder, AMCs may adopt a similar framework relating to minor and major mismatch for name and signature as provided in Annexure- 10 for RTAs under SEBI Master Circular dated February 6, 2026.



ICICI Prudential Flexicap Fund completes five years

ICICI Prudential Flexicap Fund has completed five years, the AMC said. Launched on July 17, 2021, the scheme follows an investment philosophy aiming to invest in potential high-growth opportunities through a pure bottom-up stock-picking approach. A lump-sum investment of ₹10 lakh at the time of inception, as of June 30, would be approximately worth ₹19.61 lakh, a CAGR of 14.55 per cent. In terms of SIP performance, a monthly investment of ₹10,000 via SIP since inception which would amount to a total investment of ₹6 lakh would have grown to approximately ₹8.47 lakh as of June 30, a CAGR of 13.83 per cent.



ETF movers

Top ETFs (Exchange Traded Funds) traded on NSE based on weekly change in price

	NAV (₹) as on Jul 17	Price (₹)	Weekly change in price (%)	Volume traded in the last week (in '000s)
ETF				
ICICI Prudential Nifty IT ETF	32.5	32.5	4.6	10,992
SBI IT ETF	324.2	324.3	4.6	118
Nippon India Nifty IT ETF	32.5	32.4	4.5	143,244
Kotak Nifty IT ETF	32.5	32.4	4.5	5,580
Aditya Birla SL Nifty IT ETF	32.0	31.9	4.4	729
UTI Nifty IT ETF	307.4	307.3	4.4	11
DSP Nifty IT ETF	31.0	31.0	4.4	347
GOLD ETFs				
Quantum Gold Fund	116.2	116.4	-1.6	769
Bandhan Gold ETF	140.2	140.2	-1.8	83
Union Gold ETF	137.4	137.5	-1.9	784

Source: Bloomberg. Returns as on July 17, 2026

Best NPS plans

Top pension funds in each category based on 5-year CAGR						
Name of the fund	NAV (₹) as on Jul 17	Returns (% CAGR)			Assets (₹ cr)	
		3-year	5-year	10-year		
TIER I: EQUITY PLANS						
HDFC Pension Fund	54.4	11.0	11.4	13.1	79,593	
ICICI Prudential Pension Fund	74.6	12.1	12.3	12.8	30,104	
Kotak Pension Fund	68.3	11.5	12.1	12.8	4,661	
TIER I: GOVERNMENT BOND PLANS						
LIC Pension Fund	31.6	7.1	6.6	8.2	9,161	
SBI Pension Fund	42.3	7.1	6.5	7.7	30,612	
HDFC Pension Fund	28.9	6.7	6.2	7.6	55,761	
TIER I: CORPORATE DEBT PLANS						
HDFC Pension Fund	30.8	8.0	7.0	8.2	35,566	
ICICI Prudential Pension Fund	46.3	7.8	6.8	8.0	14,201	
SBI Pension Fund	46.6	7.9	6.8	8.0	15,933	
TIER II: EQUITY PLANS						
HDFC Pension Fund	47.2	11.1	11.5	13.1	1,863	
ICICI Prudential Pension Fund	58.9	11.9	12.3	12.9	826	
Kotak Pension Fund	60.0	11.5	12.1	12.7	227	

*Source: Value Research. Returns as on July 17, 2026

Top PMS schemes

Based on 5-year returns					
AMC	Strategy	AUM (in ₹ cr)	Returns (% CAGR)		
			1-year	3-year	5-year
LARGE CAP					
Tulsian PMS	Tulsian PMS	365	11.4	24.7	25.2
Asit C Mehta Invest. Intermediates	ACE Bluechip	4	5.7	19.1	16.8
ICICI Pru	Largecap	879	1.6	18.4	16.0
Ksema Wealth	Alpha	16	-1.6	13.3	13.6
MULTI CAP					
New Berry Capitals	Seeking Alpha	9	8.2	20.3	27.3
Stallion Asset	Core Fund	8,102	12.4	36.3	24.6
Samvitti Capital	PMS Active Alpha Multicap	477	9.6	25.4	24.2
Asit C Mehta Invest. Intermediates	ACE - Multicap	117	2.9	25.8	23.0
Bonanza Portfolio	Edge	NA	-0.1	19.4	21.4
ICICI Pru	Value Strategy	1,148	8.3	21.0	21.4
MID-CAP					
Sundaram Alternate Assets	Self Portfolio	NA	32.5	23.3	17.4
Right Horizons	Super Value	NA	5.9	15.4	17.1
Nippon Life India	Emerging India	NA	4.9	17.3	16.0
NAFA Asset Managers	Emerging Bluechip	NA	-4.7	12.8	15.7
SMALL CAP					
Aequitas Invest. Consultancy	India Opportunities	2,637	32.0	34.9	33.1
Counter Cyclical Investments	Diversified Long Term Value	972	-2.9	21.7	31.0
Green Portfolio	Super 30 Dynamic Fund	242	15.3	21.4	26.9
Equitree Capital Advisors	Emerging Opportunities	1,512	-2.6	27.2	23.2

*Source: PMS Bazaar. Returns as on June 30, 2026

Kumar Shankar Roy
bl. research bureau

Road Infrastructure Investment Trust (InvIT) Cube Highways Trust is launching its nearly ₹5,000-crore public issue on July 22 and closing it on July 24.

Unlike standard new listings, Cube is converting from a privately-listed InvIT (which debuted in April 2023) into a publicly-traded vehicle now. A privately-listed InvIT pools institutional funds to invest in revenue-generating infrastructure. It is listed on stock exchanges, but trading is restricted to institutional investors.

At the upper end of the ₹151–152 price band, the issue lowers the entry barrier for investment sharply. One can bid for a single lot of 95 units (requiring ₹14,440).

The entire transaction of 32.89 crore units (not share) is structured as an Offer for Sale (OFS) by financial backers. These include British Columbia Investment Management Corporation (BCI), Abu Dhabi's Seventy Second Investment Company and the sponsor group (Cube). Consequently, the Trust will receive zero money. So, the public issue is not giving any growth capital, and investors will be funding the exit of older unit-holders.

Strategic institutions have already anchored 25 per cent of the offer (₹1,250 crore for 8.22 crore units) at ₹152 per unit. The remaining pool is split between Qualified Institutional Buyers or QIBs (75 per cent) and Non-Institutional Investors or NIIs (25 per cent). There is no separate retail quota, so they have to invest in the NII category.

At the upper band of ₹152, the issue is priced at a 4.2 per cent premium to its declared Net Asset Value (NAV) of ₹145.77 per unit (which has grown 13.6 per cent CAGR since listing).

Based on FY26 disclosures, Cube's EV/EBITDA comes to 11.7x. The independent value pegs FY26 enterprise value (EV) at ₹36,841.76 crore, which is 2.7 per cent lower than market EV.

The EV/EBITDA multiple is at the higher end of some peer road InvITs (6x-11x). Recently-listed Citius Transet InvIT, which *bl.portfolio* had recommended, came at a multiple of 5.6x.

Cube's FY26 Distribution Per Unit (DPU) implies a trailing yield of about 9 per cent. Road InvIT distributions may fluctuate with traffic, maintenance, debt servicing and concession expiries. Since highway conces-



Financial performance				
	FY24	FY25	FY26	
Enterprise value/AUM (₹ cr)	25,810.6	32,265.7	36,841.8	
Revenue from operations (₹ cr)	2,916.1	3,307.1	4,238.9	
Reported EBITDA (₹ cr)	1,368.9	2,379.7	3,234.5	
Net distributable cash flows (NDCF) (₹ cr)	1,076.2	1,082.4	1,625.7	
Net asset value per unit (₹)	126.6	132.9	145.8	
Distribution per unit (₹)	10.1	11.0	13.8	
Net debt to AUM ratio (%)	33.7	44.7	46.8	
Share of fixed-rate borrowings (%)	11.2	21.2	25.2	

AUM: Assets under management Source: RHP

sions have finite lives, NAV or unit value may decline as their residual tenures shorten, unless fresh assets offset the depletion. Hence, part of the distribution may economically represent recovery of invested capital rather than recurring income alone.

Returns could improve after the four committed assets (details below) are integrated, depending on their valuation, the number of new units issued and DPU accretion. The three ROFO (right of first offer) assets remain additional optionality.

Given that Cube's valuation and net debt/EBITDA are relatively higher on an absolute basis, investors need not subscribe now. They can wait for better visibility on DPU, portfolio life and attractive valuation.

BUSINESS

As on March 2026, Cube owned and operated 27 road assets covering 8,754 lane-km across 12 States and 1 UT. Toll assets account for 85 per cent of AUM (assets under management) and derive revenue from vehicle traffic, while annuity and HAM (hybrid annuity model) assets, forming the remaining 15 per cent, receive scheduled payments from NHAI or State authorities. In FY26, share of revenue from operations from

annuity assets was 17.4 per cent, while that from tolls was 80.5 per cent.

SEBI regulations require InvITs to distribute at least 90 per cent of their net distributable cash flows (NDCF) to unit-holders.

Cube's growth case rests on adding operational assets. It is integrating four committed assets—three toll and one annuity—with aggregate AUM of ₹7,292.53 crore through an equity swap with the sponsor group. It also has ROFO rights over three fully-operational corridors with long residual concession lives, including the Delhi-Hapur-Meerut Expressway and Kokhray-Handia stretch. These assets generated over ₹870 crore in FY25 revenue. If acquired at accretive valuations, the committed and ROFO assets could extend portfolio life, support DPU and improve investor returns.

Financial trajectory for Cube InvIT has been good. In FY26, revenue from operations grew 28 per cent year-on-year, driven by more than doubling in operation and maintenance income, near tripling of finance income on annuity receivables, primarily on account of acquisition of QEPL and JUHPL on June 12, 2025. This drove 36 per cent growth in EBITDA (74.2 per

IPO rating	
Cube Highways Trust InvIT	
Business	★★★★☆
Financials	★★★★☆
Management	★★★★☆
Valuation	★★★★☆
Overall	★★★★★
Rankings 1 to 5, 1 denoting lowest and 5 highest	
Offer period	July 22-24, 2026
Price band (per unit)	₹151-152
Implied market cap	₹20,430 cr

cent margin).

Toll tariffs generally provide for periodic escalation, though the formula varies across concessions. Some assets have WPI-linked revisions, while others provide for fixed annual increases.

FACTORS TO CONSIDER

The portfolio faces some near-term concession expiries. Western UP Tollway was handed back to NHAI in June, while Andhra Pradesh Expressway expires in September. A few other assets have residual lives of only about five years, requiring Cube to replenish expiring cash flows despite the portfolio's weighted average residual concession life of 18 years.

Periodic major maintenance causes projected debt-free cash flows to fall from ₹3,618.3 crore (17.7 per cent of m-cap) in FY28 to ₹2,635.2 crore (12.8 per cent of m-cap) in FY29. Liquidity buffers may smooth distributions, but cost overruns could hurt DPU. In InvITs, debt-free cash flow is the cash generated by infrastructure assets before paying lenders, used to distribute dividends.

The portfolio exhibits corridor risk, with Delhi-NCR, Uttar Pradesh and Tamil Nadu anchoring about 55 per cent of AUM. Stretches along a single

highway, NH-44, contribute a dominant 35.8 per cent of total toll income.

Net debt stood at ₹17,249 crore as of March, with a weighted average cost of 7.53 per cent. Net debt-to-EBITDA of 5.3x is within the road-InvIT range (3-7x) but relatively higher on an absolute basis. Interest, principal repayments and management fees will continue to absorb cash flows.

TAKEAWAYS

Cube offers a trailing pre-tax distribution yield of about 9 per cent, but given its valuations and debt levels, we prefer a wait-and-watch stance. Returns could improve if the committed assets are integrated at accretive valuations without excessive dilution, while the ROFO assets provide further optionality. Given concession depletion, leverage, maintenance requirements and interest-rate exposure, investors may wait for greater visibility on DPU and portfolio life before allocating.

Unlike REITs, unit-price performance across listed InvITs has been mixed despite their relatively-high distribution yields. Despite making distributions, total returns (XIRR %) have been weak for Roadstar Infra Investment Trust, listed in March 2025, at 1 per cent; Capital Infra Trust, listed in January 2025, at 3 per cent; and IRB InvIT Fund, listed in May 2017, at 5 per cent. Returns are calculated as on March 31, 2026.

InvIT valuations are generally sensitive to interest-rate movements, with rising bond yields tending to weigh on prices. With further domestic rate cuts appearing unlikely, the scope for rate-driven capital appreciation may be limited. If risk-free yields rise without a commensurate increase in InvIT yields or distributions, the yield spread could narrow, reducing relative attractiveness.

businessline's editorial policy prohibits analysts from taking positions in the stocks they recommend — Editor

GLOBAL BOARDROOM CHATTER.

What they say on their India plans

With India being the fastest growing large economy, 'what is your India plan?' is a common topic in boardrooms of most global corporations. One important source to distil their India plans is from their quarterly earnings calls. With the June quarter earnings season in progress, this column will present what CXOs of global corporations are saying about India, along with their perspectives and plans during the current earnings season. Here are some from companies that reported their earnings last week.

Intuitive Surgical, Inc. (ISRG, m-cap \$122 billion)

The robotic surgery company reported strong procedure momentum in India and received regulatory clearance for its latest-generation da Vinci 5 platform.

"India delivered another strong quarter across a broad range of procedures. We received clearance for da Vinci 5 and are excited to introduce the platform to customers in the market."

Jabil Inc. (JBL, \$32.5 billion)

The electronics manufacturer nearly doubled its India revenue on strong networking demand and is exploring a partnership with Adani to manufacture multi-gigawatt AI infrastructure locally.

"India revenue has nearly doubled over the past year, driven partly by rising InfiniBand and Ethernet networking demand. We are also exploring a one-stop AI infrastructure manufacturing offering with Adani, aligned with the government's 'Make in India, Make for the World' strategy, although no definitive framework, financial terms or structure has been agreed."

Expeditors International of Washington, Inc. (EXPD, \$23.8 billion)

The global logistics company reported significant disruption in India after carriers cancelled major North America-bound services, creating cargo backlogs and equipment shortages.

"Two major services from the Indian subcontinent were cancelled, causing congestion and cargo backlogs at several locations in India. Empty equipment is becoming scarce as carriers continue adjusting capacity and services across trade lanes."

FMC Corporation (FMC, \$1.4 billion)

The agricultural sciences company is tightening credit terms in India and recovering older receivables to release working capital and support free cash flow.

"We are monetising working capital from the India business by operating on a cash-only basis and collecting older receivables. These actions are helping offset restructuring related cash headwinds in a competitive market."

AB Volvo (VOLV-B, Skr 694.0 billion)

The commercial vehicle manufacturer said Indian truck demand remains supported by freight activity, infrastructure spending and replacement demand, although market momentum is beginning to moderate.

"We maintain our India forecast of 400,000 medium and heavy-duty trucks, supported by steady freight activity, infrastructure investment and government policies. However, softer conditions in India are contributing to a lower outlook and book-to-bill ratio for Asia."

Elekta AB (publ) (EKTA-B, Skr 18.3 billion)

The radiation therapy company sees a significant opportunity to expand cancer care in underserved India through affordable treatment systems and a remotely connected hub-and-spoke model.

"We will position Harmony as a productivity platform for India, combining adaptive treatment and hypofractionation with remote collaboration. Specialist clinicians at central hubs can plan treatments for regional centres, creating a price-competitive model that reduces the need for patients to undertake costly and difficult travel."

Templeton Emerging Markets Investment Trust plc (TEM, £2.9 billion)

The emerging markets investment trust is using India's market correction to increase exposure, narrowing its longstanding underweight to a broadly neutral position, although it continues to prefer China.

"India remains a compelling long-term growth market, but high valuations and earnings expectations are now correcting. We have used the downturn to build positions and narrowed our underweight to broadly neutral, including US-listed Indian companies. However, we added more to China recently, as India's greater oil dependence increases its vulnerability to the Iran conflict."

Contributed by JNAFA ASSET MANAGERS

WHO AM I?.

Are you an avid investor? How well do you know corporate India?

Here's a challenge. Using the five clues below, identify the company that is being talked about here

- I am just entering my silver jubilee year. I began my journey as a subsidiary of a national leader in another business and was listed separately 10 years ago following a spin-off.
- I had three founders, though only two continue to remain promoters, as one exited by selling his stake to a potential competitor.
- My CMD, who is also my largest shareholder, continues to purchase my shares from the market. He was awarded the Padma Shri for his unique contribution to education in underdeveloped areas.
- My market capitalisation crossed the ₹10,000-crore mark only last year. While I have just a 1 per cent share of the national market, I am a leader in the region where I operate.
- Though my sales and profit growth, as well as shareholder returns, have remained below 12 per cent annually since listing, I am hopeful of faster growth, driven by the aggressive expansion currently underway.

Send your answers by Wednesday 6 p.m. to who-am-i@thehindu.co.in, with your full name, postal address and phone number. A lucky winner in each week will get a book sponsored by UNIFI Capital as a reward.

Contributed by UNIFI CAPITAL Investing With Conviction

Last week's stock: Aegis Logistics Last week's winner: Mihir Mishra

Hot Summer follows cool growth

CONSUMER DURABLES. While LG Electronics' prospects remain strong, higher valuation makes the risk-reward balanced

Sai Prabhakar Yadavalli
bl. research bureau

LG Electronics India, the industry leader in consumer durables segment, was listed on October 10, 2025. We recommended investors subscribe to the issue, given its strong position in the industry and reasonable valuation.

At the upper end of the price band, the IPO was valued at 35 times FY25 earnings compared to peer valuation range of 42-65 times FY25 earnings. The stock has returned 38 per cent since then and has closed the valuation gap with peers.

But the company reported a muted performance in FY26, as the consumer durables industry was impacted by weak Summer sales and geopolitical events. The upcoming season looks strong with a hot Summer and weak base of sales last year.

The long term prospects remain good with the company having lined up several strategic initiatives, which should further support growth. But given higher valuation now and execution risks, the risk reward appears balanced. Hence while more attractive valuation is required to add on to positions, existing investors can continue to hold the stock for the long term.

LG Electronics reports two segments: Home Appliances – HA (74 per cent of FY26 revenues) that includes washing machines, RACs (room air conditioners), refrigerators and now even dishwashers; Home Entertainment – HE accounts for the rest and includes TVs, information displays and soundbars. The company has built leading market shares in several categories: 33 per cent in washing machines, 30 per cent in refrigerators and 43 per cent in premium refrigerators, 17 per



cent in RACs for year-to-date December 2025. The company's strengths include the leading market share and a well-diversified portfolio.

It will be supplementing its strength with several other drivers to support growth.

GROWTH DRIVERS

The primary driver is the company's third plant, being developed at Sri City, Andhra Pradesh, at a cost of ₹5,000 crore over the next three-four years, which should double capacity. The company has deployed ₹657 crore by March 2026 and expects to start production of compressor units by Q3FY27 and RACs by Q4FY27. In a phase-wise development, washing machine and refrigerator production facilities will be added later.

But the facility development should also support the company's Essential series line and export targets as well.

LG Electronics primarily serves premium markets in most segments. It is adding a mass-premium segment, which includes affordable products in its Essential series. This is aimed at increasing its market share and positioning on a wider price range. The launches so far under Essential series include 8-kg top loader washing machines, 225-litre refrigerators, air fryers/ovens and sub-1 tonne

HOLD

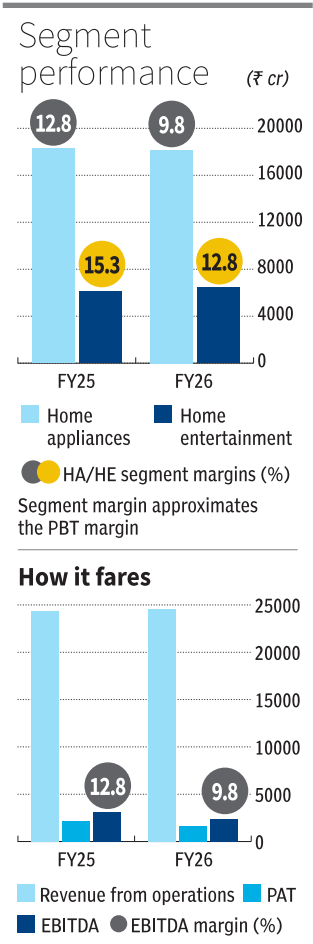
LG Electronics India ₹1,582.20

WHY

- Revenue and margin levers present
- Strong Summer benefits industry
- Valuations at a premium

RACs; the company has reported satisfactory traction so far. The mass-premium segment should improve the operating leverage and increase the company's market share in the long term, further strengthening its market position.

The company has an export revenue of 5-6 per cent in FY26, which it plans on doubling in the short term of one-two years. The existing Pune facility is designed to cater to export markets and so will the upcoming Sri City facility. This includes side-by-side refrigerators, top freezers and front-loading washing machines on the product side and a dedicated team on the administrative side. The export strategy will also be dual-focused. The company looks to initiate premium markets, with exports to the US and Europe supported by the free trade agreements. The mass-



premium segments served by the Essential series will be targeted towards 22 of the 53 countries it already has a presence in. Even at the time of IPO, the Indian arm and South Korean parent were intent on developing India as the global export hub, and post-IPO the company is executing this plan.

Apart from mass-premium and export expansion, the company will also be increasing its institutional focus through annual maintenance contracts. The HVAC (heating, ventilation, ACs) segment focusing on corporate and hospitality segments, IT parks and govern-

ment infrastructure projects has a strong order-book as well.

FINANCIALS, VALUATION

The company reported a 1 per cent revenue growth in FY26 to ₹24,605 crore while PAT declined by 24 per cent to ₹1,685 crore. A delayed and a milder Summer in the year and geopolitical uncertainty impacted growth in several segments, including RACs. This performance was despite the GST revision in H2FY26, which provided strong tailwinds to the consumer durables industry.

The margin impact was even higher which explains the decline in PAT. The lower scale of operations and additional impact from rupee depreciation (import cost of materials), higher commodity costs (copper and aluminium) and recycling costs impacted the margins. The company also compensated its channel partners with additional promotional schemes to sustain its leading market share as well. The EBITDA margins in FY26 at 9.8 per cent was 300 bps lower than the previous year.

The company targets a mid-teen revenue growth and early double-digit EBITDA margin in FY27. While the revenue drivers are as discussed, the margins levers follow from the same. A higher-margin product mix from exports and BEE (Bureau of Energy Efficiency)-transitioned portfolio, which is 10-12 per cent higher on prices (already implemented), is a strong support. The company will improve the locally-sourced material (55 per cent currently) by 150 bps every year, which will also aid margins. The higher operating leverage from the Essential series, Sri City and exports will also have a positive impact on margins.

With one-year forward valuations at 45 times earnings, the positives are factored in.

Akhil Nallamuthu
bl. research bureau

Nifty 50 (24,334) and Nifty Bank (58,521) gained 0.5 per cent and 0.8 per cent, respectively, last week, extending their recovery. The gains came despite a sharp decline in open interest in the July futures contracts ahead of the monthly expiry. While a part of the drop can be attributed to rollover activity, the derivatives positioning indicates that institutional sentiment improved.

Foreign Institutional Investors (FIIs) turned less bearish. Their net short position in index futures declined 15 per cent to 2.17 lakh contracts from 2.55 lakh contracts. More notably, net short positions in index call options plunged 68 per cent to 69,411 contracts from 2.19 lakh contracts, while net long positions in index put options eased 17 per cent to 3.98 lakh contracts from 4.79 lakh contracts. The sharp reduction in bearish call positions suggests that institutional investors have moderated their negative outlook.

The broader positioning, however, remained mixed. Combined FII-retail net short positions in index futures declined 17 per cent to 70,562 contracts from 85,080 contracts, reflecting lower bearish exposure. But net short positions in index call options surged 56 per cent to 2.81 lakh contracts, indicating aggressive call writing at higher levels. Meanwhile, net put shorts narrowed sharply to 72,873 contracts from 1.51 lakh contracts, indicating that put writers have scaled back their bullish bets.

Overall, the derivatives data points to improving institutional sentiment, although the broader market remains cautious. On the charts, Nifty has reclaimed the 24,300 level, while Bank Nifty has moved above 58,500.

While we have suggested

Positive signs

F&O TRACKER.
Short covering lifts indices above key technical levels

trades below, we would like to mention that the risk is higher given the geopolitical uncertainties. Therefore, risk-averse traders can refrain from initiating fresh positions.

NIFTY 50
Nifty futures (Jul) (24,322), after opening with a gap-up last Monday, saw a strong recovery during the same session. However, the rally lacked follow-through and the contract drifted lower over the subsequent sessions. The decline, though, was limited as support emerged at lower levels. A strong rally on Friday eventually lifted the contract above the resistance at 24,300.

Despite the rally, open interest (OI) in July futures declined from 166 lakh contracts to 146 lakh contracts over the past week, indicating short covering. The Put Call Ratio (PCR) also continues to reflect a positive bias, with the July and August series standing at 1.14 and 1.19, respectively, on Friday.

Overall, while the derivatives data does not indicate an outright bullish signal such as fresh long build-up, it points to an improving bias for Nifty futures.

As long as the contract sustains above 24,300, it can witness

DERIVATIVES MARKET

- FIIs less bearish
- Key hurdles crossed
- Caution persists

another leg of the rally towards 24,570. A breakout above this level can pave the way for an advance to 24,750.

Alternatively, if Nifty futures slips below 24,300, it can retest the support zone of 24,000-23,900. A breach of 23,900 will weaken the outlook and expose the contract to a decline towards 23,600. A break below 23,600 can accelerate the fall to 23,250.

Overall, with Nifty futures having reclaimed the 24,300 level, the bulls hold a slight edge.

Strategy: Although Nifty futures has moved above 24,300, we recommend waiting for a breakout above 24,400 to avoid a false breakout. Buy above 24,400 with a stop-loss at 24,100. Once the contract rises to 24,570, revise the stop-loss higher to 24,450. Book profits at 24,750.

NIFTY BANK
Nifty Bank futures (Jul) (58,534) also spent most of the week in negative territory before staging

a sharp rally on Friday. The move was accompanied by a decline in open interest from 21.5 lakh contracts to 20 lakh contracts, indicating short covering.

The PCR of the July series improved from 0.94 on July 10 to 1.01 on July 17. This is a positive sign as the increase was driven by relatively higher put writing.

Overall, the futures and options data continues to support a constructive outlook for Nifty Bank futures.

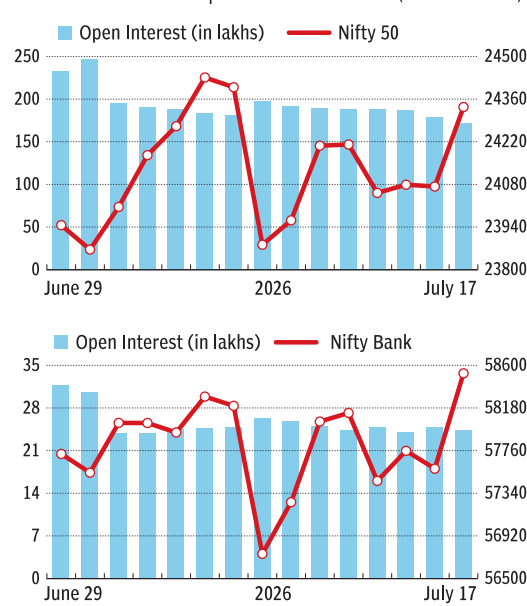
Although there is an immediate resistance at 59,000, the contract is likely to surpass this level and rally towards 60,000, a notable resistance. A breakout above 60,000 can extend the up-move to 61,000.

On the downside, if Nifty Bank futures slips below the immediate support at 58,300, it can decline to 57,500. The next important support lies at 57,000. A breach of this level will turn the outlook bearish and can drag the contract towards 56,000.

As long as Nifty Bank futures remains above 58,300, the probability of a rally towards 60,000 remains high.

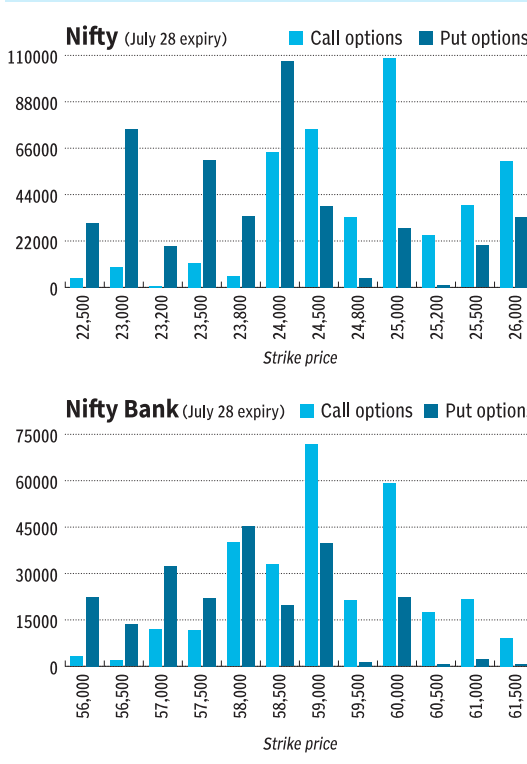
Strategy: Buy Nifty Bank futures (Jul) on a breakout above 58,700. Place a stop-loss at 58,000. Exit at 60,000.

Cumulative Open Interest (Futures)



Open Interest chain

Put-Call ratio Nifty **1.13** Nifty Bank **1.01** (as on July 17)



Change in Open Interest (OI)

Scrip	FII		Retail	
	As on Jul 17	Weekly change %	As on Jul 17	Weekly change %
Future Index Long	30554	-11	219094	-5
Future Index Short	247082	-15	73128	21
Net Futures	-216528	-15	145966	-14
Index Call options Long	584454	12	2387972	-11
Index Call options Short	653865	-12	2599692	-1
Net Call options	-69411	-68	-211720	-645
Index Put options Long	1048195	-1	3123046	12
Index Put options Short	650336	12	3593778	5
Net Put Options	397859	-17	-470732	-25

FIIs have reduced net short on index futures. Also, they have cut net short on index calls and net long on index puts. The change in positioning is bullish.

Stocks that witnessed major change in OI

Company	Price (₹)	Weekly price change %	OI (in lakh)	Weekly OI change %
RISE (as on Jul 17)				
ICICI	1,612.20	-11.7	155.5	125.1
POLYCAB	8,862.00	-3.8	103.3	124.5
PATANJALI	337.70	-18.4	744.6	111.5
TORNTPHARM	4,763.00	-2.8	68.3	71.6
TATAELXSI	3,503.20	-5.1	110.9	64.9
FALL (as on Jul 17)				
TCS	2,269.00	9.7	945.7	-11.8
MARICO	844.00	-1.0	267.7	-9.6
MCX	2,747.50	-0.8	206.2	-8.9
SWIGGY	276.87	1.3	837.8	-5.8
INDIANB	832.40	-4.4	394.8	-5.8

Stocks in F&O ban (for trade on Jul 20)

KAYNES

Change in OI and market positioning

Symbol	Expiry date (2026)	Price (₹)	OI (Weekly change %)	Indication
COMMODITIES (as on Jul 17)				
ALUMINIUM	31-Jul	343.0 (1.3)	3,215 (-18)	Short covering
COPPER	31-Jul	1,302.4 (0.7)	11,959 (-3)	Short covering
CRUDEOIL	20-Jul	7,945.0 (16.6)	5,386 (-71)	Short covering
CRUDEOILM	20-Jul	7,946.0 (16.6)	12,025 (-59)	Short covering
GOLD	5-Aug	1,40,906.0 (-1.8)	6,554 (-34)	Long unwinding
GOLDGUINEA	31-Jul	1,13,870.0 (-1.5)	15,193 (-8)	Long unwinding
GOLDM	5-Aug	1,40,782.0 (-1.8)	48,611 (-2)	Long unwinding
GOLDPETAL	31-Jul	14,222.0 (-1.5)	1,70,541 (-21)	Long unwinding
GOLDTEN	31-Jul	1,41,105.0 (-1.8)	29,555 (1)	Short build-up
LEAD	31-Jul	199.0 (-0.8)	484 (-10)	Long unwinding
NATURALGAS	28-Jul	281.7 (0.5)	30,513 (-18)	Short covering
SILVER	4-Sep	2,16,403.0 (-2.8)	13,109 (13)	Short build-up
SILVERM	31-Aug	2,19,825.0 (-2.6)	31,522 (11)	Short build-up
SILVERMIC	31-Aug	2,19,886.0 (-2.6)	1,09,163 (9)	Short build-up
ZINC	31-Jul	373.2 (-0.9)	2,530 (-9)	Long unwinding
CURRENCIES (as on Jul 17)				
USDINR	29-Jul	96.35 (0.9)	19,02,249 (48)	Long build-up
EURINR	29-Jul	110.11 (0.7)	6,214 (7)	Long build-up
GBPINR	29-Jul	129.83 (1.1)	26,141 (-2)	Short covering
JPYINR	29-Jul	59.50 (0.2)	112 (9)	Long build-up

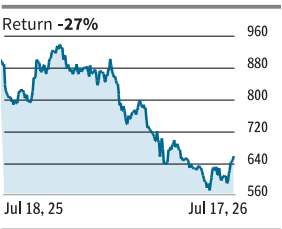
F&O Strategy

Buy SBI Cards call

KS Badri Narayanan

The stock of SBI Cards and Payment Services (₹654.70) is ruling at a crucial level. Immediate resistance levels are ₹685 and ₹759. Nearest support is at ₹638, followed by ₹568. We expect the stock to sustain the current recovery trend.

Event: SBI Cards and Payment Services is scheduled to announce its Q1 FY27 financial results on July 24, and hence may remain volatile.



F&O outlook: SBI Cards July futures closed at ₹654.35 and August futures at ₹647.40 against the spot close of ₹654.70. The counter witnessed steady build-up in open positions in the last few days along with a rise in share price movement. However, the discount signals existence of shorts. Option trading indicates that the stock could move between ₹600 and ₹700.

Strategy: Consider buying August 650-call, which closed with a premium of ₹26.05. As the market lot is 800 shares, this strategy would cost ₹20,840, which would be the maximum loss. On the other hand, the profit potentials are high if the stock moves up sharply. The maximum loss occurs if SBI Cards slips below ₹650.

Hold the position with an initial stop-loss at ₹15. This can be shifted to ₹20, if the stock opens on a flat-to-positive note. We advise traders to hold the positions for two weeks. Target can be ₹40-42.

Follow-up: We had recommended put on ITC. The stock moved on expected lines, but did not provide entry point.

Note: The recommendations are based on technical analysis and F&O positions. There is a risk of loss in trading

Short Take

Using PCR for trading

bl. research bureau

Selling options require higher margins and the ability to take more risks, as theoretically the loss is unlimited for a limited profit which one receives as the premium. In that sense, selling options is generally done by sophisticated participants such as large institutions and high net-worth individuals.

By this logic, calls and puts with highest open interest (OI) are assumed to act as resistances and supports, respectively. However, this is not a given and this logic can fail. As the market dynamics vary, these large institutions might change their view and may take fresh positions or modify existing trades accordingly.



We should also remember that large investors and traders will generally implement multi-legged strategies. This means rather than buying or selling plain-vanilla call or put options, they can go for a combination of both and there is no limit to the ways in which such strategies can be designed and executed.

So, as traders, one should always track how Put Call Ratio (PCR) changes over time, rather than looking at it on one particular day. For instance, one should see how the PCR varies and in what direction the market has been moving over a period. Suppose if PCR has been declining and the market is up, it is a bullish signal irrespective of who buys or sells options.

The long and short of options

MASTERING DERIVATIVES. The probability that the option you short will expire worthless is high

Venkatesh Bangaruswamy

Retail traders mostly go long on options whereas professional traders typically use options to capture time decay. That is, they initiate short option positions that combine with their primary position which may be futures contract. Some retail traders create naked short positions. They base their argument on empirical evidence that about 85 per cent of the out-of-the-money (OTM) options expire worthless. This week, we discuss the risks you should be aware of before initiating a naked short position.

SKewed RETURNS

Arguing that 85 per cent of OTM options expire worthless does not give a complete picture. Reports suggest that about 70 per cent of the traded option contracts are closed before expiry. Of the remaining contracts that are carried till expiry, about 15 per cent end in-the-money (ITM). The remaining 85 per cent expire worthless. The probability that the option you short



MANAGING RISKS

Combining short option positions with a primary position helps you manage the risk of loss and yet provides the opportunity to capture gains from time decay

will expire worthless is very high, but the magnitude of gains is low. This is because the maximum gains you get from shorting is the

premium collected when you initiate the position. The probability that the option you short will expire ITM is low, but the magnitude of loss is high. In other words, short option strategies have a negatively skewed returns distribution. That is, you make small frequent gains but large infrequent losses. You should prefer a positively skewed returns distribution.

The issue is that prices can jump. That is, an underlying price can gap-up or gap-down. Whereas gap-down may lead to modest gains, gap-up can push an OTM call into ITM. That is an issue because intrinsic value of a call option moves one-to-one with the underlying. That causes significant losses, as the increase in an option price from intrinsic value (loss for shorts) is more than the decrease in price due to time decay (gain for shorts). Combining short option positions with a primary position helps you manage the risk of loss and yet provides the opportunity to capture gains from time decay. Importantly, it reduces trading

capital because of cross-margin benefits offered by the NSE.

OPTIONAL READING

When the underlying moves up, call delta will increase, boosted by its gamma. Only the theta works against a long position. We ignore the vega effect for this discussion. In contrast, when an underlying declines, call delta and theta work against the long position with the gamma working in its favour. Now, delta is a more significant factor than the gamma. Therefore, the long call position loses significantly when the underlying declines. A short call position has the opposite effect – potential gains are more than losses, for a given change in the underlying. This tempts traders to create naked short positions. The issue is that an underlying can go up sharply, resulting in significant losses to the short position (short delta and gamma).

The author offers training programmes for individuals to manage their personal investments

Oil back in bullish territory

CRUDE CHECK. Technical charts indicate further upside after a sharp correction in May and June

Akhil Nallamuthu

bl. research bureau

Crude oil prices have remained highly volatile this year, driven by a combination of geopolitical tensions and changing market dynamics. The outbreak of war fuelled the rally as concerns over supply disruptions intensified, lifting Brent crude and MCX crude oil futures sharply.

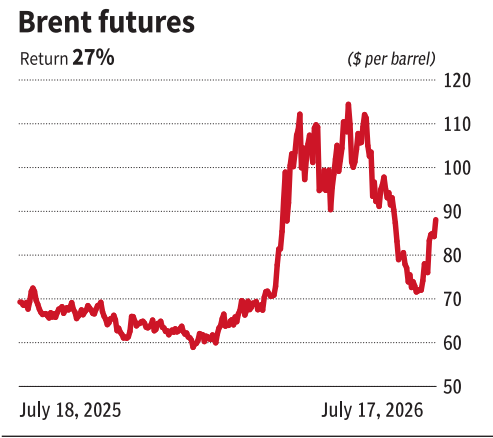
However, after encountering resistance in April, both contracts reversed course and declined rapidly through May and June as fears of immediate supply disruptions eased. The correction, much like the preceding rally, was swift. Buying interest has resurfaced, supported by renewed supply concerns.

So far this year, Brent crude futures and MCX crude oil futures have gained about 45 per cent and 52 per cent respectively. Over the past one year, the contracts are up 27 per cent and 37 per cent, respectively. Against this backdrop, here is the technical outlook on both contracts.

BRENT CRUDE FUTURES

(₹88.10/BARREL)

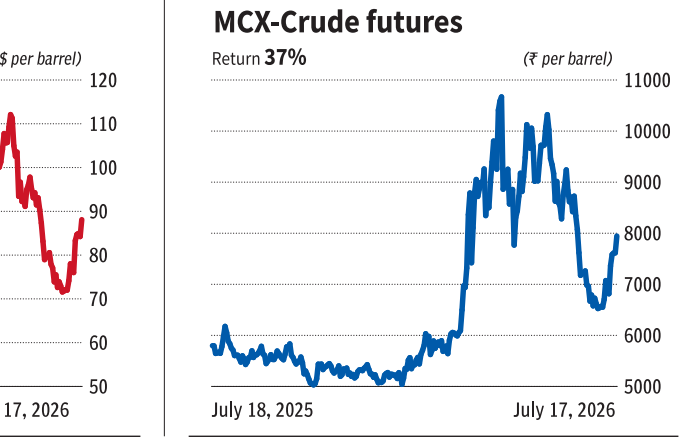
Brent crude futures, which was down about 18 per cent and 20



per cent in May and June respectively, rebounded on the back of the support at \$70 early this month. It is now hovering around the resistance at \$88, its 50-day moving average.

As it stands, the momentum looks positive and Brent crude futures is likely to decisively surpass \$88. Once this happens, the contract can rally to \$100. A breach of this can lift it to the \$115-120 price region.

However, if the price declines from the current level, Brent futures can find support at \$77 and \$70. A break down below \$70 can keep the price suppressed below



this resistance and could eventually trigger a decline to \$58-60 support band. Immediate notable support below \$58 is at \$50.

Overall, as it stands, the bias is bullish and so, a rally to \$100 appears very likely. This could extend to \$115.

MCX CRUDE OIL FUTURES

(₹7.945/BARREL)

MCX Crude oil futures, like Brent crude futures, lost 16 per cent and 20 per cent in May and June respectively. A couple of weeks ago, the contract started to recover on the back of the base at ₹6,400.

The nearest barrier is at ₹8,000. A breakout of ₹8,000 can take the contract to the ₹9,200-9,400 price band. If the bulls can push the price above ₹9,400, a rally to ₹10,500 and ₹11,000 will become a reasonable possibility.

In case the ongoing rally fizzles out and the crude oil futures take a turn downwards, it can slip to ₹7,000 and ₹6,400. In case the support at ₹6,400 is breached, the bears will gain considerable strength and the price could remain below ₹6,400 for quite some time. Notable support levels below ₹6,400 can be spotted at ₹5,800 and ₹5,500.

Gurumurthy K
bl. research bureau

Nifty 50, Sensex and the Nifty Bank index remained stable in a narrow range until Thursday. However, on Friday, the benchmark indices witnessed a strong rise. The movement last week indicates a lack of strong sellers in the market. That keeps our overall bullish view intact. We expect the Nifty and Sensex to break their upcoming resistance and go higher in the coming weeks.

Nifty Bank index, on the other hand, has risen well within its range. We expect the index to make a bullish breakout of its range and move up, going forward.

FPIS SELL
After buying for four consecutive weeks, the foreign portfolio investors (FPIs) turned net sellers of Indian equities last week — they sold about \$336 million in the equity segment.

NIFTY 50 (24,334.30)
Short-term view: Nifty managed to sustain very well above 24,000 all through last week. The outlook is positive. Immediate resistances are at 24,400 and 24,500. We expect the Nifty to breach 24,500 and rise to 24,800 or even 24,950 in the coming weeks.

After this rise, a corrective dip to 24,500-24,400 is a possibility. A fresh leg of rally thereafter can take the Nifty up to 25,500 and higher.

Supports are at 24,000 and 23,800. Nifty has to decline below 23,800 to become negative for a fall to 23,600 and lower. But that looks less likely.

Medium-term view: Nifty is attempting to go up within its broad 22,000-26,500 range now. A break above 24,950 can trigger the rise towards 26,500.

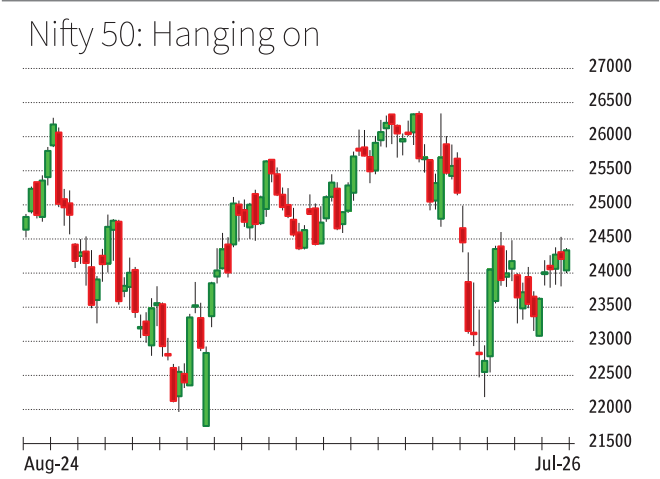
The bias remains positive. Nifty can make a bullish breakout above 26,500 and rise to 28,000 and even 30,000 in the long term.

This bullish view will get negated only if the index declines below 22,000. That looks less likely at the moment.

NIFTY BANK (58,521.40)
Short-term view: The index has risen well within its 56,500-58,900 range. We need to see if the long-awaited bullish breakout above 58,900 will happen now or not. Such a break can take the Nifty Bank index higher

Poised to rise

INDEX OUTLOOK. The price action last week indicates lack of strong sellers in the market



to 60,500 and 61,500.

A break below 56,500 is needed to turn the short-term picture negative. If that happens, a fall to 56,000 or 55,500 can be seen.

Medium-term view: The broader picture remains positive. Nifty Bank index is likely to breach the key resistance level of 61,500. That will clear the way for a rally to 65,000 in the medium term. It will also keep the doors open to target 68,000-69,000 in the long term.

Key supports are at 53,500 and 50,000. Nifty Bank index has to decline below 50,000 to negate the bullish view.

SENSEX (78,151.45)
Short-term view: After getting support in the 77,000-76,800 region, Sensex has risen well towards the end of the week. Resistance is in the 78,800-79,000 region, which can be tested this week. We expect the Sensex to breach 79,000 for a rise to 81,000-81,500 in the

SHORT-TERM TARGETS

- Nifty 50: 24,800, 24,950
- Sensex: 81,000, 81,500
- Nifty Bank: 60,500, 61,500

short term.

Failure to breach 79,000 can drag the index down to 78,000 again. The level of 76,000 is a strong support. The short-term picture will turn negative only if the index declines below 76,000.

Medium-term view: The broader range of 71,000-86,000 remains intact. Sensex is likely to go up towards 86,000, the upper end of the range, in the medium term. A break above 81,500 can trigger this rise.

Eventually, a bullish breakout above 86,000 is likely to be seen in the coming months. Such a break will trigger a fresh rally to 90,000 and even 94,000 in the long term.

NIFTY MIDCAP 150 (22,967.90)
The resistance at 23,300 has held well. The Nifty Midcap 150

index has come down after touching a high of 23,239.65. A fall to 22,750 looks likely this week. A bounce thereafter can take the index higher to 23,000-23,300 again. But a break below 22,750 can drag the index down to 22,550.

We retain our overall bullish bias. So, eventually, we expect to see a bullish breakout above 23,300. Such a break can take the Nifty Midcap 150 index higher to 26,000-26,500 initially in the medium term. It will also open the doors for the index to target 28,000-28,500 in the long term.

The above-mentioned rise will get delayed if the index breaks below 22,550 from here. If that happens, a fall to 22,000-21,800 and even lower levels can be seen.

From a big picture perspective, 21,000-20,800 is a crucial support zone for the Nifty Midcap 150 index. Our bullish view will go wrong completely, only if the index declines below 20,800. That looks less likely for now.

NIFTY SMALLCAP 250 (18,003.50)

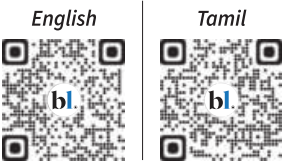
The price action last week indicates the absence of fresh buyers to take the index above 18,200. Immediate support is at 17,880. A break below it can drag the Nifty Smallcap 250 index down to 17,500. If the index manages to bounce back thereafter, then a rise to 18,000-18,200 can be seen again. In that case, 17,500-18,300 can be the trading range for some time.

That, in turn, will keep our overall bullish bias intact. An eventual break above 18,300 can boost the momentum. It can then take the Nifty Smallcap 250 index up to 22,500-23,000 in the medium term and 24,000-25,000 in the long term.

If the index breaks below 17,500 from here, an extended fall to 17,300 and even lower levels can be seen. In that case, the expected rally breaking above 18,300 will get delayed.

bl.portfolio
video

Watch bl. Guru share the Nifty and Bank Nifty technical outlook for this week

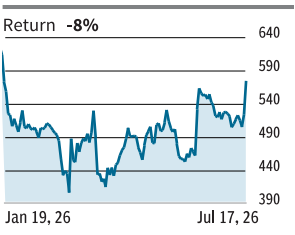


MOVERS & SHAKERS

AKHIL NALLAMUTHU, bl. research bureau

Authum Investment & Infrastructure (₹571.30)

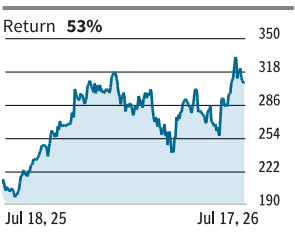
Steady uptrend



The stock has been rallying since the beginning of the current financial year. The price action since early April shows that the scrip has been forming higher highs and higher lows, indicating a steady uptrend. Last week, the stock rebounded from the 50-day moving average and the rally on Friday indicates that there is much more upside left. From the current level, we might see the price moderating to ₹530. But post this move, the stock can appreciate to ₹700 over the next few months. So, traders can go long now at ₹571 and accumulate at ₹530. Place stop-loss at ₹480. On a rally to ₹630 and ₹670, alter the stop-loss to ₹580 and ₹640 respectively. Exit at ₹700.

L&T Finance (₹309)

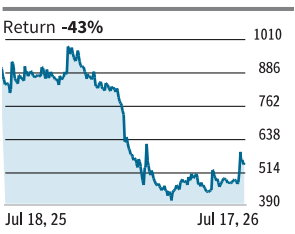
Rally to resume



level of ₹309, its 21-day moving average, or after extending the fall to ₹290. Once the uptrend resumes, the stock can rally to ₹400 in the medium term. Hence, participants can buy now at ₹309 and accumulate on a dip to ₹290. Place stop-loss at ₹275. On a rally to ₹340 and ₹375, raise the stop-loss to ₹315 and ₹360 respectively. Exit at ₹400.

Newgen Software Technologies (₹548.35)

Trend sees a reversal



The stock of Newgen Software Technologies has been in a downtrend since January 2025. But since March this year, the price remained largely flat, showing that the bears lost momentum. Adding to this, the stock broke out of a barrier at ₹530 last week, a notable signal of a bullish trend reversal, at least of the near term. Over the medium term, the price might go up to ₹800. Hence, the risk-reward ratio is good. Therefore, one can buy the stock now at ₹548 and ₹515. Keep stop-loss at ₹450. When the price touches ₹650, raise the stop-loss to ₹580. Tighten the stop-loss to ₹680 when the stock rises to ₹730. Book profits at ₹800.

US MARKET OUTLOOK. Absence of a follow-through rise is a negative

Gurumurthy K
bl. research bureau

The Dow Jones Industrial Average fell for the second consecutive week. The index was down 0.93 per cent for the week. The S&P 500 and the Nasdaq Composite index, on the other hand, snapped their two-week rise. The indices fell 1.55 per cent and 2.90 per cent respectively. The recent price action indicates that the US benchmark indices are struggling to rise. This signals the absence of fresh buyers in the market. We suggest remaining cautious at the moment rather than being overly bullish on the US indices.

DOW JONES (52,151.22)

The index is struggling to rise past 53,000. Immediate support is at 52,000. A break below it can drag the index down to 51,700-51,650, the next key support zone. A bounce from this support zone can take the Dow Jones up to 52,000 and higher again.

But a break below 51,650 can increase the selling pressure. It will also indicate that a top is in place. In that case, 51,000 can be seen first. It will also keep the downside open to see 50,000-49,000 eventually in the coming weeks.

S&P 500 (7,457.70)

The resistance at 7,600 continues to cap the upside. The index hovered around 7,580 for most part of the week and fell sharply on Friday. Key supports are at 7,430 and 7,400. A decisive break below 7,400 will be bearish, triggering a potential fall to 7,200-7,100.

If the index manages to sustain above 7,400, it can rise back and remain inside a range of 7,400-7,600. A decisive break above 7,600 is needed to strengthen the bullish case for a rise to 7,800. The price action in the 7,430-7,400 region will need a close watch this week.



KEY RESISTANCE

The dollar index has to breach the 101-101.20 resistance to gain strength and rise towards 103

NASDAQ COMPOSITE (25,520.24)

The Nasdaq Composite index failed to get a strong follow-through rise last week. A strong fall below 26,000 on Friday leaves the bias negative. Key support is at 25,000. A break below it can drag the Nasdaq Composite index down to 24,500 and even 24,000 in the coming weeks.

The region between 26,000 and 26,500 is a key resistance. A sustained rise above 26,500 is needed to take the index higher towards 28,000.

DOLLAR OUTLOOK

The dollar index (100.75) declined below the support at 100.60, but that was short-lived. The index has risen back from the low of 100.35. The immediate outlook is slightly unclear. Strong resistance is in the 101-101.20 region. As long as the index stays below the 101-101.20

resistance zone, the near-term bias will remain negative. A fall to 100.20-100 is possible in that case.

The dollar index has to breach 101.20 to gain a bullish momentum. Only then the upside will open up for a rise to 103. Such a rise will keep the doors open for the dollar index to see 105-106 in the medium term.

TREASURY YIELD

The US 10Yr Treasury Yield has come off after touching a high of 4.64 per cent last week. The broader picture remains positive. Immediate support is at 4.5 per cent. Below that, 4.4 per cent is the next important support, which can be tested if the yield breaks below 4.5 per cent. However, a fall beyond 4.4 per cent is less likely.

As long as the yield stays above 4.4 per cent, the outlook will remain bullish. A reversal — either from here or after a dip to 4.4 per cent — can take the 10Yr yield up to 4.6 per cent again. A sustained rise above 4.6 per cent can take the US 10Yr Treasury Yield up to 4.8 per cent in the medium term.

A decisive break below 4.4 per cent is needed to negate this bullish view.

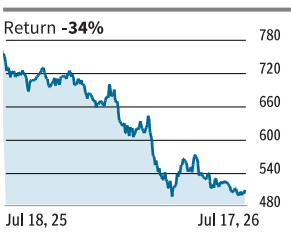
TECH QUERY



GURUMURTHY K, bl.research bureau

I have bought IRCTC shares at ₹1,000. What should I do now?

Tejas Sonar

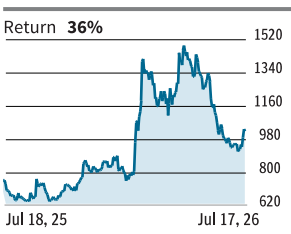


IRCTC (₹507): The stock is in a strong downtrend since May 2024. There is no sign of a reversal. Resistance is in the ₹560-580 region. The stock has to rise above ₹580 to get a breather. If that happens, a rise to ₹700

is possible. But that looks less likely. There is a danger of the price tumbling to ₹300 or ₹260. You have to accept the loss and exit now. Always remember that a stop-loss is a must whenever you enter a trade. It will help in minimising the loss. It will also avoid getting stuck in a wrong position for a prolonged period of time. So, next time you enter any trade, ensure a stop-loss at the first place and strictly adhere to it.

What is the outlook for Avanti Feeds? My purchase price is ₹860.

Kiran, Mohali

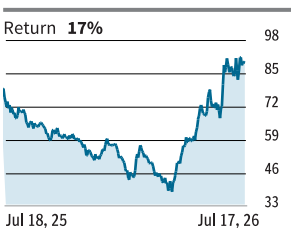


Avanti Feeds (₹1,029): The bounce from the low of ₹906 made early this month is happening from an important trendline support. This gives an early indication that the corrective fall that was in place since April could have ended.

A strong follow-through rise from here can take the price up to ₹1,200 or even ₹1,350. From a long-term perspective, this will also keep the upside open to see ₹1,800 over the next one year. Keep a stop-loss at ₹885 and hold the stock. Move the stop-loss up to ₹1,050 when the price goes up to ₹1,190. Revise the stop-loss higher to ₹1,280 and ₹1,540 when the price touches ₹1,390 and ₹1,680 respectively. Exit the stock at ₹1,780.

Can I book profits in Lloyds Engineering Works? I bought the stock at ₹62.

Reema, Noida

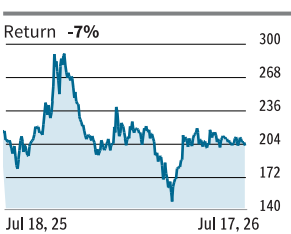


Lloyds Engineering Works (₹88.50): The stock has surged in the last three months. Support is around ₹80. As long as the stock stays above this support, uptrend will remain intact. The stock can rise to ₹102 from

here. It is now important for you to protect your profits. Keep a stop-loss at ₹78 and hold the stock. When the price goes up to ₹95 and ₹98, move the stop-loss up to ₹88 and ₹93, respectively. Exit the stock at ₹101. The region around ₹102 is a strong resistance. There are good chances for the stock to see a downward reversal from there. So, you will have to exit at the level mentioned above rather than becoming more bullish at that point of time.

I have shares of Mindteck (India). My average purchase price is ₹249. Should I continue to hold or exit?

Yash Mankad



Mindteck (India) (₹203): The stock is oscillating between ₹140-300 for more than a year now. From a long-term perspective, the bias is positive. Strong supports are at ₹160 and ₹140. Resistance is at ₹260. A strong break

above it will increase the chances for the stock to rise beyond ₹300. That in turn will trigger a fresh rally to ₹500 over the next couple of years. You can accumulate at current levels and also at ₹170 if a dip happens. Keep the stop-loss at ₹120. Move the stop-loss up to ₹220 as soon as the stock reaches ₹290. Revise the stop-loss higher to ₹320 and ₹430 when the price touches ₹370 and ₹460, respectively. Exit the stock at ₹490.

Send your queries to techtrail@thehindu.co.in

BANDU'S BLOCKBUSTERS.

On April 1, four years back, piqued by the incessant jokes in the village at his expense, Bandu Barve decided he'd had enough. It was time for him to turn 'smart'. His dead granny's voice rang in his ears — "Read the papers, Bandya, they tell you all." So, off went Bandu to the stash of newspapers on his father's desk. As luck would have it, the first paper Bandu got his hands on was The Hindu businessline. The stock recos, in particular, had him in thrall. Soon Bandu metamorphosed into an ace investor and trader.

These days, Bandu picks five stocks each Sunday, which he believes will be blockbusters over the next week

1

Zee Entertainment Enterprises

2

India Cements

3

SBI Cards & Payment Services

4

Lloyds Metals & Energy

5

Bajaj Finance

Last week's prize winner
K Narendra Kumar

Last week's winning stock
Ather Energy

Closing price (July 10)
₹1,224.25

Closing price (July 17)
₹1,281.34

Return:
4.66 per cent

Here's your chance to match step with Bandu. Guess the stock that will give the best return by next Friday (BSE prices). By Wednesday noon, mail us your pick and its expected price rise to bandublockbuster@gmail.com with your name, mobile number and address. One lucky winner will get a prize of ₹2,000.

Scan to know the winner selection process

The Benchmark indices, Sensex and Nifty 50 were up 0.8 and 0.5 per cent respectively last week. BSE IT gained the most by 3.7 per cent, followed by BSE Consumer Durables and BSE Teck 2.2 per cent each. BSE Realty and BSE Metal declined by 2.1 and 1.7 per cent respectively last week.

	Nifty 50	Sensex	Auto	Bankex	Capital Goods	Consumer Durables	FMCG	Healthcare	IT	Metal	Oil & Gas	Power	PSU	Realty	Teck
P/E	21.0	21.2	36.6	14.9	53.5	69.7	33.2	44.3	19.4	18.5	8.3	34.6	11.0	43.5	20.6
P/BV	3.1	4.2	7.2	2.4	15.2	17.4	7.7	5.8	5.8	3.2	1.6	5.1	2.2	5.7	7.7
Dividend Yield	1.2	1.1	1.1	0.7	0.5	0.5	1.0	0.5	2.2	0.6	3.0	1.1	2.2	0.3	1.7
Weekly Return (%)	0.5 ▲	0.8 ▲	0.5 ▲	0.8 ▲	-1.2 ▼	2.2 ▲	-1.1 ▼	-0.3 ▼	3.7 ▲	-1.7 ▼	0.8 ▲	-0.6 ▼	-0.3 ▼	-2.1 ▼	2.2 ▲
Monthly Return (%)	1.0 ▲	1.3 ▲	1.3 ▲	2.0 ▲	-5.1 ▼	3.9 ▲	-1.0 ▼	5.8 ▲	0.3 ▲	-4.3 ▼	-0.9 ▼	-3.9 ▼	-2.1 ▼	12.8 ▲	0.1 ▲
Annual Return (%)	-3.1 ▼	-5.0 ▼	11.1 ▲	4.1 ▲	9.6 ▲	5.1 ▲	-13.0 ▼	9.6 ▲	-22.9 ▼	28.1 ▲	-5.2 ▼	12.2 ▲	4.3 ▲	-7.8 ▼	-16.1 ▼

The sector indices are disseminated by BSE PSE.

Company	CMP	EPS	PE	PB	Year End	Sales Qty	Profit Qty	Sales TTM	Profit TTM	Wkly Rtn	ROCE	DER	Yr-High	Yr-Low
360 One [1]	3114.3	31.0	35.9	4.6	202606	34.5	16.1	36.8	19.5	-1.3	14.3	0.0	1235.7	906.2
3M India [1]	34880.4	542.7	64.3	18.3	202606	0.3	21.6	3.0	23.3	-1.3	39.8	0.0	38300.0	28747.3
A B B [2]	7509.9	71.9	104.5	20.3	202603	5.8	-25.2	14.8	-3.3	9.9	9.8	0.1	7923.4	4640.5
A B Lifestyle [1]	94.9	1.7	55.5	8.2	202603	11.9	-57.8	7.2	29.4	-0.7	11.7	2.3	15.9	8.7
A B Real Estate [1]	1452.4	-27.0	4.4	202603	-79.1	-877.4	-66.4	-605.4	0.6	-4.1	1.4	22280.0	1080.1	
Aadhar Hsg. Fin. [1]	516.7	25.3	20.7	3.0	202603	18.2	27.0	18.2	21.5	-3.2	11.3	2.5	563.0	425.1
AAR Drillers [5]	345.5	1.2	46.1	1.4	202603	1.9	25.2	1.9	52.2	-1.9	52.2	0.0	332.2	33.2
AASVS Financials [1]	1480.9	61.9	23.9	3.1	202403	21.4	12.3	25.4	14.2	-2.7	9.9	3.2	1960.1	1050.3
Abbott India [1]	28013.6	730.4	38.4	12.5	202603	6.5	7.6	8.1	9.7	3.3	45.0	0.03520	025164.0	
ACC [1]	1377.7	112.4	12.3	1.3	202603	16.9	62.9	17.3	-9.0	-0.5	11.2	0.0	1995.0	1250.0
ACME Solar Hold. [2]	385.2	32.1	94.1	3.5	202603	12.5	0.0	18.5	15.6	2.2	5.6	1.5	3245.0	1735.3
Action Const.Eng. [1]	988.3	34.9	28.4	5.9	202603	1.1	-6.5	-1.4	-0.1	-0.2	4.0	0.0	1169.3	746.1
Acutaeas Chemical [5]	3614.8	43.5	83.1	17.9	202603	40.3	110.9	33.0	124.5	6.5	20.1	0.1	3175.0	1126.0
Adani Energy Sol. [1]	1722.8	19.0	90.7	8.1	202603	16.8	5.7	16.1	-4.0	4.2	9.5	1.9	1577.6	745.5
Adani Enterp. [1]	1514.3	16.1	196.5	4.5	202603	20.3	-124.0	2.6	-48.0	0.2	5.6	1.5	3245.0	1735.3
Adani Green [1]	1514.3	11.6	135.0	12.9	202603	17.7	40.1	11.6	8.0	1.4	8.0	0.0	1631.3	767.0
Adani Ports [2]	1837.2	56.3	32.6	4.4	202603	26.5	11.4	27.1	14.9	0.5	13.8	0.7	1891.8	1291.0
Adani Power [2]	214.5	6.7	32.2	6.7	202603	0.0	52.3	-3.5	-0.8	-1.8	16.6	0.8	254.2	110.5
Adani Total Gas [1]	706.7	5.0	118.5	16.0	202603	16.1	8.9	17.9	0.2	-2.4	14.8	0.5	859.7	453.5
Amba AMC [5]	131.5	33.8	34.1	8.3	202603	15.7	18.5	15.6	15.6	32.5	0.0	122.0	70.8	19.9
Aditya Bkr. Fas. [1]	57.8	-6.1	1.2	202603	15.7	-184.0	11.2	-4.9	-3.7	0.0	1.3	95.0	3.5	13.6
Aditya Birla Cap. [1]	401.8	13.9	28.9	2.9	202603	10.2	29.4	12.1	15.1	-1.6	9.5	4.4	40.7	244.0
Aditya Infotech [1]	3618.2	11.2	115.8	22.7	202603	45.5	20.7	35.6	160.5	-1.4	28.1	0.3	3865.0	1014.7
Aegis Logistics [1]	1348.9	25.6	52.7	18.8	202603	52.2	45.7	23.2	35.0	-1.7	16.1	0.8	2194.9	1976.0
Aegis Vopak Term. [1]	271.4	2.3	119.1	8.8	202603	22.2	17.6	25.8	75.0	-4.2	8.7	1.9	311.5	158.8
Aether Invest. [1]	1476.9	17.0	86.6	8.0	202603	27.0	4.8	38.3	35.3	-1.3	9.7	0.1	1538.4	723.2
Aikons Infotech [1]	299.7	8.5	35.4	2.0	202603	-18.9	-179.7	-4.8	-36.0	-0.3	10.5	0.6	479.1	265.9
AIRTEL [2]	158.3	41.7	26.1	2.4	202603	16.8	26.0	15.9	16.5	0.0	16.0	0.0	218.0	151.3
AIA Engineering [2]	4646.3	136.4	34.1	5.4	202603	5.6	37.9	0.1	317.50	300.6	1.9	0.0	1215.4	300.6
Ajanta Pharma [2]	341.6	84.5	40.4	9.4	202603	21.5	18.4	17.3	14.7	-2.0	31.8	0.0	350.5	233.0
Alkem Lab [2]	5552.9	201.8	27.5	4.8	202603	14.6	3.6	13.5	11.4	-2.1	20.0	0.1	5933.0	374.0
AILW [2]	12.3	-1.5	74.9	2.4	202603	1.0	1.0	1.0	1.0	0.0	1.0	0.0	1.0	1.0
Alok Industries [1]	12.3	-1.5	-0.3	202606	6.5	-178.8	3.9	18.6	-2.1	0.0	0.0	2.3	11.1	
Amaraj Raja Ener. [1]	907.7	38.5	23.6	2.1	202603	15.5	11.6	7.5	-18.9	-2.2	15.6	0.0	1058.0	71.1
Amber Enterp. [1]	7042.2	57.1	136.7	6.3	202603	10.5	-26.8	22.2	17.3	0.3	13.5	0.8	8970.0	5404.0
Amulja Cements [2]	438.7	20.0	21.9	1.8	202603	9.4	108.2	15.4	15.5	0.6	6.7	0.0	626.0	394.0
Anand Rathil Wea. [1]	280.6	27.8	74.5	33.6	202606	18.2	77.0	22.9	46.6	-3.5	57.1	0.1	2215.4	1251.0
Anant Raj [2]	59.5	15.4	38.4	3.7	202603	19.6	23.6	19.9	30.4	0.9	12.0	0.1	74.1	40.3
Angel One [1]	321.0	11.3	29.1	4.9	202606	25.4	102.1	9.1	3.8	-5.0	14.8	1.0	360.2	208.9
Anglo Eastern [1]	1776.9	25.6	72.7	11.8	202603	4.0	12.9	5.2	35.0	-0.7	11.1	0.0	1294.9	1051.2
Apac Inds. [1]	13820.8	249.1	10.3	202603	26.6	3.7	23.3	21.8	32.6	-1.9	32.6	0.1	17148.0	6800.0
APOL Apollo Tubes [2]	1793.7	43.3	41.4	9.4	202603	14.1	20.9	9.7	58.9	-2.3	22.0	0.2	2300.9	1493.0
Apollo Hospitals [2]	882.3	136.0	64.8	13.4	202603	18.1	35.9	15.8	75.5	-0.2	17.5	0.6	9008.9	6680.0
Apollo Tyres [1]	340.6	33.6	12.8	1.6	202603	14.2	254.7	10.0	32.3	-2.2	13.4	0.3	543.0	365.4
Asahi Value Hold. [2]	134.7	1.0	138.2	1.0	202603	16.7	26.0	25.2	7.9	0.0	16.6	0.0	364.0	193.5
Asahi Inds. Ltd. [1]	882.4	13.9	63.6	5.7	202603	15.5	43.2	7.8	1.7	-3.6	3.1	0.9	1073.0	775.1
Ashtok Leyland [1]	155.2	6.4	24.4	6.4	202603	17.1	9.0	15.9	20.9	-1.5	14.9	4.3	215.4	110.0
Ashtor Finpnt. [1]	238.2	46.3	51.2	2.4	202603	15.8	36.2	15.8	43.6	0.4	10.0	0.0	285.5	211.0
Aster DM Health. [1]	820.0	17.7	15.6	20.9	202603	18.8	39.1	12.2	17.6	-4.4	11.6	0.5	840.0	518.9
Astral [1]	1377.8	20.6	66.9	9.1	202603	24.2	21.2	12.6	5.6	3.3	20.8	0.1	1768.0	1262.8
Ather Energy [1]	1281.4	-13.4	19.1	202603	73.7	-142.8	62.8	36.9	4.7	0.0	0.0	1343.0	329.0	
Atul [1]	6145.2	30.3	26.7	2.9	202603	15.0	66.1	12.4	40.1	-1.5	14.9	0.0	7484.8	5563.0
Aurobindo Pharma [1]	1534.1	61.1	25.1	2.4	202603	4.4	2.0	6.4	-1.8	-2.0	14.2	0.2	1636.0	1017.0
Authum Invest [1]	571.3	22.7	25.1	3.3	202603	-78.6	-96.6	-43.0	-54.5	11.2	29.7	0.1	683.5	400.0
Avenue Super. [1]	3950.0	46.9	84.2	10.5	202606	14.9	11.3	15.6	13.0	-3.3	18.0	0.0	4916.3	3528.7
Axis Bank [2]	188.7	13.9	14.0	1.9	202603	15.7	15.7	15.7	15.7	0.0	15.7	0.0	188.7	15.7
Axis Bank [2]	132.9	89.3	14.9	1.9	202606	9.9	22.2	5.6	-0.3	0.4	0.0	0.0	1418.3	1041.3

BHEL [2]	421.9	7.0	60.4	5.6	202606	40.3	-17.3	27.0	739.4	6.7	5.6	0.3	446.8	205.2
BPCCL [1]	315.5	60.3	5.2	1.4	202603	6.7	26.1	3.4	92.1	1.9	15.7	0.7	391.9	266.6
Bajaj Auto [1]	10437.5	392.0	26.6	7.4	202603	40.2	101.6	22.6	47.1	2.7	28.4	0.4	10835.0	8795.5
Bajaj Finance [1]	1055.2	30.8	34.2	5.8	202603	18.4	22.0	19.4	15.4	3.5	10.9	0.8	11075.8	788.4
Bajaj Finserv [1]	1859.9	62.9	29.6	3.8	202603	5.3	5.0	13.2	13.4	-2.9	11.8	5.2	2194.7	158.2
Bajaj Holdings [1]	10392.2	736.5	14.1	1.6	202603	-58.3	49.2	56.3	25.7	-2.5	12.6	0.4	14753.5	8597.5
Bajaj Housing [1]	86.3	3.1	28.0	3.2	202603	15.7	14.1	16.6	18.8	-2.0	8.8	4.4	124.1	72.6
Balkrishna Inds [2]	2067.3	64.3	32.1	3.7	202603	6.6	18.7	3.6	24.9	-8.3	10.9	0.8	2400.2	1971.5
Bank of Baroda [1]	604.1	17.9	33.7	2.8	202603	6.7	30.4	15.8	13.4	-0.7	11.6	5.2	623.9	393.4
Bandhan Bank [2]	213.2	7.6	28.1	1.4	202603	-0.1	68.0	-1.2	-55.4	-4.7	0.0	0.0	220.7	134.3
Bank of Baroda [2]	246.7	38.4	6.4	0.8	202603	5.2	7.0	4.6	-4.2	-1.7	10.1	0.0	325.6	231.0
Bank of India [1]	143.2	23.5	6.1	0.8	202603	5.9	18.7	6.0	11.9	-1.1	0.0	0.0	174.5	110.0
Bank of Maha [1]	79.8	9.8	8.1	1.8	202606	13.9	34.5	15.8	31.0	-5.3	0.0	0.0	94.5	51.7
Bank of India [5]	63.5	12.8	54.0	5.6	202603	5.0	58.6	0.8	29.1	0.3	14.6	0.9	1281.6	605.6
Bayer Crop Sci. [1]	4237.4	153.4	27.6	6.4	202603	5.2	13.1	3.7	21.3	2.6	23.8	0.0	6540.0	4030.0
Belrise India [5]	22.7	5.6	40.4	3.9	202603	12.2	17.5	14.7	40.8	-1.8	14.1	1.1	252.0	100.0
BEMIL Ltd [1]	1811.8	17.0	106.8	5.1	202603	8.6	37.5	8.2	-51.7	-2.7	11.7	1.1	2325.0	1361.1
Bergart Paints [1]	409.3	10.0	49.4	8.3	202603	6.1	17.3	2.9	-12.2	-0.7	24.8	0.1	594.2	393.5
Bharat Electronics [5]	105.2	1.2	109.5	1.9	202603	3.3	58.3	3.3	58.3	-1.3	36.8	0.0	105.2	1.2
Bharat Electron [1]	409.4	8.3	49.4	12.5	202603	11.7	4.6	16.2	13.3	-1.7	26.9	0.0	473.3	361.1
Bharti Group [2]	2189.8	24.6	89.1	10.9	202603	17.5	2.1	11.2	13.8	3.5	11.7	0.9	2237.0	1100.5
Bharti Tele [1]	105.2	1.2	109.5	1.9	202603	3.3	58.3	3.3	58.3	-1.3	36.8	0.0	105.2	1.2
Bharti Hexacom [5]	160.67	35.1	45.7	11.2	202603	4.4	-1.1	14.6	30.0	0.0	16.5	1.5	195.5	134.0
Bajaj Foods [1]	639.0	10.4	61.3	10.0	202603	19.0	26.1	15.1	30.2	-0.6	18.4	0.2	820.9	591.6
Billionbricks [2]	437.0	17.8	18.1	2.1	202603	61.6	11.5	5.4	37.7	30.8	18.6	0.1	227.0	112.0
Birlasoft Ltd [2]	288.2	19.4	14.9	2.0	202603	2.4	-4.1	-1.2	-4.9	-0.7	20.0	0.0	473.8	270.2
BISL International [1]	235.7	16.7	14.1	3.9	202603	17.6	31.6	36.7	35.1	-0.7	39.0	0.1	415.0	218.5
Blue Dart Express [1]	4926.6	139.9	41.1	6.6	202603	8.2	11.3	7.4	12.7	0.1	17.1	0.7	7030.3	4365.0
Blue Star [2]	626.8	17.9	14.9	2.0	202603	2.4	-4.1	-1.2	-4.9	-0.7	20.0	0.0	473.8	270.2
Bosch [1]	408.3	79.4	51.8	8.1	202603	13.3	3.0	10.8	15.6	-2.2	21.0	0.4	425.50	286.50
Brinabees Solut. [2]	211.2	-2.5	2.3	2.0	202603	12.0	-123.1	11.6	10.2	-0.4	0.0	0.4	43.8	202.7
Bridge Enterprise [1]	566.8	20.1	28.2	2.7	202603	-0.2	-42.1	-2.3	-4.4	-1.3	13.2	1.2	856.4	463.3
Broadcom [1]	104.3	1.2	109.5	1.9	202603	3.3	58.3	3.3	58.3	-1.3	36.8	0.0	105.2	1.2



bl. rating	Scheme Name	Latest NAV (₹)	Latest Corpus (₹ Cr.)	Expense Ratio (%)		Trailing Returns (%)				Sortino Ratio (%)
				Regular	Direct	1 Year CAGR	3 Year CAGR	5 Year CAGR	10 Year CAGR	

EQUITY - LARGE CAP FUNDS

*****	ICICI Pru Large Cap	109.2	79421	1.1	0.7	-1.2	12.5	13.1	13.3	0.43
*****	Invesco India Largecap	71.8	1847	1.8	0.7	2.8	13.2	12.2	12.6	0.36
*****	Nippon Ind Large Cap	90.5	53227	1.2	0.6	-0.4	12.5	15.0	14.0	0.48
*****	Baroda BNP Paribas Large Cap	219.6	2571	1.7	0.7	-1.2	11.5	11.3	12.0	0.38
*****	Canara Robeco Large Cap	61.8	16692	1.4	0.5	-2.4	10.1	9.9	13.2	0.33
*****	JM Large Cap	152.8	409	2.1	0.8	-0.7	10.8	11.1	10.7	0.32
*****	SBI Large Cap	94.3	55064	1.2	0.7	1.2	9.8	10.8	11.8	0.34
***	Aditya Birla SL Large Cap	519.7	29029	1.4	0.8	-2.1	10.4	10.8	11.5	0.31
***	Bandhan Large Cap	78.3	2061	1.8	0.8	1.3	12.1	11.7	12.3	0.33
***	DSP Large Cap	461.4	7190	1.5	0.8	-3.5	12.1	10.5	10.9	0.32
***	Edelweiss Large Cap	83.3	1434	1.8	0.6	-0.9	9.8	10.5	12.2	0.30
***	Franklin Ind Large Cap	1017.1	7256	1.5	0.9	-1.0	10.1	8.8	10.2	0.24
***	HDFC Large Cap	1139.0	39024	1.3	0.8	-0.3	10.7	12.5	12.4	0.38
***	HSBC Large Cap	474.5	1814	1.8	1.0	0.4	10.2	10.0	11.7	0.27
***	Kotak Large Cap	569.6	10772	1.8	0.7	-0.8	10.6	10.4	12.1	0.30
***	Mah Manu Large Cap	22.3	700	2.0	0.6	-4.0	9.0	9.0	-	0.24
***	Tata Large Cap	515.4	2721	1.7	0.8	2.3	11.1	11.0	11.6	0.32
***	Groww Largecap	42.9	132	2.4	1.1	0.0	10.2	9.9	10.7	0.27
**	Mirae Asset Large Cap	112.9	38379	1.3	0.5	-0.5	9.2	9.3	12.4	0.25
**	Union Largecap	23.2	437	2.1	1.3	-1.6	8.3	9.0	-	0.24
**	UTI Large Cap	266.2	11976	1.5	0.8	-2.9	8.0	8.5	11.1	0.21
*	Axis Large Cap	60.0	30913	1.3	0.7	-0.7	8.6	7.2	11.6	0.16
*	LIC MF Large Cap	53.3	1362	1.8	0.9	-5.8	7.2	7.5	9.9	0.18
*	PGIM India Large Cap	332.7	539	2.1	0.8	-2.3	7.0	7.2	9.6	0.17
-	Taurus Large Cap	161.9	52	2.1	1.9	2.2	13.0	10.7	9.9	0.28

EQUITY - LARGE & MID CAP FUNDS

*****	Bandhan Large & Mid Cap	140.3	18783	1.4	0.5	4.0	19.0	16.6	15.3	0.51
*****	ICICI Pru Large & Mid Cap	1034.7	30971	1.3	0.7	2.6	16.8	17.1	15.1	0.59
*****	Quant Large & Mid Cap	125.0	3450	1.7	0.6	6.8	16.3	15.7	15.6	0.44
*****	Axis Large & Mid Cap	34.4	16469	1.4	0.6	5.3	14.9	12.5	-	0.34
*****	HDFC Large and Mid Cap	347.3	29285	1.4	0.8	0.5	14.9	15.5	14.4	0.47
*****	Invesco India Large & Mid Cap	109.6	11164	1.5	0.6	7.3	23.2	17.2	16.3	0.47
*****	UTI Large & Mid Cap	185.4	6218	1.6	0.8	1.8	16.6	14.8	13.9	0.48
***	BOI Large & Mid Cap Equity	97.2	491	2.1	1.0	4.7	14.4	12.0	12.7	0.36
***	DSP Large & Mid Cap	627.7	17906	1.4	0.5	0.4	15.7	12.7	14.4	0.39
***	Edelweiss Large & Mid Cap	90.0	4683	1.6	0.5	2.8	14.6	12.9	14.3	0.39
***	HSBC Large & Mid Cap	29.3	5344	1.6	0.7	10.2	17.9	14.8	-	0.37
***	Kotak Large & Midcap	355.9	31263	1.6	0.6	3.5	15.0	14.3	15.0	0.42
***	Mirae Asset Large & Midcap	157.5	44048	1.3	0.5	3.5	13.7	11.8	16.4	0.34
***	Nippon Ind Vision Large & Mid Cap	1492.3	7459	1.5	1.0	1.6	16.5	14.6	12.8	0.45
***	SBI Large & Midcap	655.5	40850	1.3	0.6	3.7	14.2	13.9	14.8	0.45
**	Canara Robeco Large and Mid Cap	254.9	25251	1.4	0.5	-2.0	12.7	11.3	14.7	0.32
**	Franklin Ind Large & Mid Cap	191.2	3450	1.7	1.1	-1.6	12.5	10.8	11.3	0.31
**	LIC MF Large & Midcap	39.0	3093	1.7	0.5	-0.9	14.4	12.2	14.2	0.36
**	Sundaram Large and Mid Cap	90.5	6991	1.6	0.7	5.6	14.1	12.9	14.2	0.37
*	Aditya Birla SL Large & Mid Cap	933.1	5784	1.6	0.9	2.2	11.7	8.6	11.2	0.21
*	Navi Large & Midcap	36.4	310	2.1	0.5	1.9	9.2	11.0	12.5	0.31
*	Tata Large & Mid Cap	505.1	7887	1.5	0.6	-6.3	8.1	10.5	12.3	0.30

EQUITY - FLEXI CAP FUNDS

*****	HDFC Flexi Cap	2043.6	106496	1.1	0.6	2.7	16.8	17.8	15.6	0.60
*****	JM Flexicap	98.1	5178	1.6	0.6	-0.6	15.3	16.4	16.0	0.47
*****	Parag Parikh Flexi Cap	83.4	143388	1.1	0.5	-1.6	13.8	12.9	16.8	0.49
*****	Aditya Birla SL Flexi Cap	1922.2	26727	1.4	0.7	6.8	15.2	12.3	13.9	0.36
*****	Edelweiss Flexi Cap	38.8	3484	1.7	0.5	1.7	14.2	12.7	14.2	0.37
*****	Franklin Ind Flexi Cap	1612.0	19274	1.4	0.8	-2.4	13.4	13.4	12.9	0.39
*****	HSBC Flexi Cap	226.0	5633	1.6	0.9	1.9	15.6	13.3	12.6	0.36
***	Axis Flexi Cap	27.5	13328	1.5	0.7	2.2	12.4	9.7	-	0.25
***	Bandhan Flexi Cap	211.4	7417	1.5	0.9	0.7	12.2	11.0	10.8	0.32
***	Canara Robeco Flexi Cap	342.0	13328	1.5	0.5	-0.2	11.4	10.6	13.9	0.31
***	DSP Flexi Cap	104.0	12236	1.5	0.6	0.0	12.5	10.5	13.8	0.28
***	Kotak Flexicap	86.0	55850	1.4	0.6	0.2	12.8	11.6	13.1	0.33
***	Navi Flexi Cap	24.6	281	2.1	0.5	7.5	10.6	11.2	-	0.32
***	PGIM India Flexi Cap	36.6	5818	1.6	0.5	0.2	9.2	8.5	13.3	0.23
***	Union Flexi Cap	52.2	2376	1.7	0.8	1.1	11.4	11.0	12.9	0.31
**	LIC MF Flexi Cap	103.6	1053	1.9	0.9	3.9	11.5	10.6	10.0	0.28
**	Motilal Oswal Flexi Cap	60.6	13294	1.4	0.7	-3.5	18.2	12.1	12.5	0.30
**	SBI Flexicap	107.8	22685	1.4	0.7	-1.0	8.4	8.8	11.6	0.25
**	Tata Flexi Cap	24.0	3639	1.6	0.6	-3.2	11.3	10.2	-	0.18
**	Shriram Flexi Cap	19.9	133	2.1	0.7	-2.5	7.5	7.9	-	0.28
**	Taurus Flexi Cap	229.8	349	2.8	0.6	12.2	10.4	9.6	11.6	0.28
*	UTI Flexi Cap	318.3	22882	1.4	0.8	-2.6	8.0	6.0	11.5	0.12
-	Quant Flexi Cap	108.7	7140	1.5	0.6	9.2	16.9	14.9	19.0	0.41

EQUITY - MULTI CAP FUNDS

-	Baroda BNP Paribas Multi Cap	295.5	3339	1.7	0.8	2.7	14.9	14.2	14.1	0.39
-	ICICI Pru Multicap	847.9	18194	1.4	0.8	4.9	16.9	15.1	14.5	0.51
-	Invesco India Multicap	129.8	4302	1.6	0.6	-2.4	13.5	11.3	13.3	0.31
-	ITI Multicap	25.6	1470	1.8	0.5	7.2	16.8	12.0	-	0.33
-	Mah Manu Multi Cap	38.2	6926	1.6	0.4	4.8	17.1	15.4	-	0.43
-	Nippon Ind Multi Cap	303.2	54585	1.2	0.6	0.0	15.8	18.8	15.3	0.59
-	Quant Multi Cap	663.2	7761	1.5	0.6	3.8	11.6	12.1	17.4	0.32
-	Sundaram Multi Cap	387.3	2915	1.7	0.8	0.0	13.8	12.8	14.4	0.37

EQUITY - MID CAP FUNDS

*****	Edelweiss Mid Cap	107.7	17748	1.4	0.4	5.3	22.0	17.9	18.2	0.52
*****	Nippon Ind Growth Mid Cap	4479.7	49169	1.2	0.6	6.6	21.1	19.1	18.2	0.58
*****	Quant Mid Cap	224.3	8138	1.5	0.6	1.6	14.6	15.5	17.1	0.43
*****	HDFC Mid Cap	206.9	100858	1.1	0.6	4.1	19.3	19.4	17.5	0.61
*****	Invesco India Midcap	198.0	13767	1.5	0.5	8.0	24.5	19.4	18.6	0.53
*****	Mah Manu Mid Cap	36.3	5076	1.6	0.4	7.2	20.7	17.3	-	0.50
*****	Motilal Oswal Midcap	99.1	37474	1.3	0.7	-4.2	18.7	21.9	16.6	0.55
***	Baroda BNP Paribas Mid Cap	111.5	2513	1.7	0.5	9.9	18.5	15.2	15.4	0.45
***	HSBC Midcap	453.1	15352	1.5	0.6	15.7	24.5	17.9	16.9	0.47
***	ICICI Pru Midcap	336.3	7846	1.5	0.9	10.5	22.7	17.1	16.4	0.52
***	Kotak Midcap	146.4	67611	1.4	0.4	6.7	19.6	17.1	17.4	0.49
***	PGIM India Midcap	65.6	10981	1.5	0.5	-0.7	11.2	11.4	15.3	0.33
***	SBI Midcap	243.3	24127	1.4	0.7	1.2	12.4	14.2	13.9	0.44
***	Sundaram Mid Cap	1487.4	14026	1.5	0.7	6.4	20.7	17.7	14.8	0.52
***	Tata Mid Cap	463.8	5868	1.6	0.6	5.2	17.7	15.7	16.1	0.46
**	Aditya Birla SL Midcap	839.6	6624	1.6	0.9	4.4	17.4	14.9	13.6	0.43
**	Axis Midcap	120.2	33803	1.3	0.5	5.2	16.9	13.9	16.8	0.40
**	Franklin Ind Mid Cap	2821.0	12490	1.5	0.8	0.0	17.7	14.5	14.2	0.39
**	UTI Mid Cap	308.3	12122	1.5	0.7	0.4	12.8	12.4	13.1	0.35
**	DSP Midcap	154.1	20170	1.4	0.6	3.3	16.8	11.8	14.7	0.33
**	LIC MF Midcap	30.3	369	2.1	1.1	1.6	17.2	13.1	-	0.35
**	Taurus Mid Cap	121.5	125	2.7	2.2	-3.3	11.1	11.3	14.2	0.29

EQUITY - SMALL CAP FUNDS

*****	Bank of India Small Cap	54.9	2572	1.7	0.5	12.8	20.9	17.9	-	0.45
*****	Quant Small Cap	286.1	32739	1.3	0.6	8.0	19.5	18.4	19.9	0.46
*****	Edelweiss Small Cap	47.1	6580	1.6	0.4	3.2	16.4	16.5	-	0.46

bl. rating	Scheme Name	Latest NAV (₹)	Latest Corpus (₹ Cr.)	Expense Ratio (%)		Trailing Returns (%)				Sortino Ratio (%)
				Regular	Direct	1 Year CAGR	3 Year CAGR	5 Year CAGR	10 Year CAGR	

★★★★★	Invesco India Smallcap	47.0	13385	1.5	0.4	8.6	22.5	18.8	-	0.49
★★★★★	Nippon Ind Small Cap	180.4	78407	1.1	0.5	2.8	16.9	18.7	20.5	0.51
★★★★★	Union Small Cap	57.0	2268	1.7	0.8	13.7	18.0	15.9	16.3	0.42
★★★★	AXIS Small Cap	113.4	29394	1.4	0.6	3.1	15.3	15.6	18.4	0.47
★★★★	Canara Robeco Small Cap	40.4	13967	1.5	0.4	-0.4	13.1	14.8	-	0.42
★★★★	DSP Small Cap	221.6	19635	1.4	0.7	8.0	18.0	17.1	16.5	0.46
★★★★	HSBC Small Cap	86.7	17830	1.4	0.6	1.5	15.5	16.9	18.0	0.42
★★★★	Kotak Small Cap	268.5	18691	1.7	0.6	-0.9	12.7	12.8	16.5	0.34
★★★★	LIC MF Small Cap	33.3	743	2.0	0.8	5.6	16.9	17.0	-	0.43
★★★★	Sundaram Small Cap	288.8	3872	1.6	0.7	7.9	17.8	16.2	14.5	0.43
★★★	Franklin Ind Small Cap	178.6	14336	1.5	0.8	-0.4	15.3	16.4	14.9	0.43
★★★	HDFC Small Cap	140.0	40417	1.3	0.6	-2.9	12.6	14.9	17.1	0.41
★★	ICICI Pru Smallcap	88.6	9379	1.5	0.7	-1.5	11.7	13.2	15.6	0.44
★★	Tata Small Cap	38.3	12529	1.5	0.4	-9.1	11.5	14.2	-	0.37
★	Aditya Birla SL Small Cap	95.5	5731	1.6	0.8	6.9	15.7	12.3	12.9	0.32
★	SBI Small Cap	181.1	40157	1.3	0.6	1.1	12.7	13.7	17.8	0.39

EQUITY - FOCUSED FUNDS

bl rating	Scheme Name	Latest NAV (₹)	Latest Corpus (₹ Cr.)	Expense Ratio (%)		Trailing Returns (%)				AA & Below
				Regular	Direct	1 Month *Ann	3 Month *Ann	6 Month *Ann	1 Year CAGR	

CASH FUNDS

LIQUID FUNDS

- 360 ONE Liquid	2137.3	1153	0.3	0.2	6.1	5.8	6.4	6.0	-
- Aditya Birla SL Liquid	448.5	63687	0.3	0.2	6.6	6.3	6.7	6.3	-
- Axis Liquid	3100.6	44866	0.2	0.1	6.6	6.4	6.8	6.3	-
- Bandhan Liquid	3359.2	15800	0.2	0.1	6.5	6.2	6.6	6.2	-
- Bank of India Liquid	3206.4	1339	0.1	0.1	6.6	6.4	6.7	6.3	1.90
- Baroda BNP Paribas Liquid	3197.7	8087	0.2	0.1	6.5	6.2	6.6	6.2	0.90
- Canara Robeco Liquid	3349.5	5182	0.1	0.1	6.6	6.2	6.7	6.3	-
- DSP Liquidity	3974.4	19371	0.2	0.1	6.6	6.3	6.7	6.3	-
- Edelweiss Liquid	3560.7	12259	0.2	0.1	6.6	6.4	6.8	6.3	-
- Groww Liquid	2691.2	279	0.2	0.1	6.5	6.3	6.7	6.3	-
- HDFC Liquid	5459.3	65878	0.3	0.2	6.5	6.2	6.7	6.3	-
- HSBC Liquid	2774.2	19663	0.2	0.1	6.6	6.3	6.7	6.3	-
- ICICI Pru Liquid	411.8	54543	0.3	0.2	6.6	6.3	6.6	6.2	-
- Invesco India Liquid	3825.6	16797	0.2	0.1	6.6	6.4	6.7	6.3	-
- ITI Liquid	1446.1	50	0.2	0.1	6.4	5.9	6.3	6.1	-
- JM Liquid	75.8	1759	0.2	0.1	6.4	6.2	6.6	6.2	-
- Kotak Liquid	5623.1	39817	0.3	0.2	6.6	6.3	6.7	6.2	-
- LIC MF Liquid	5030.1	13416	0.2	0.1	6.7	6.3	6.7	6.3	-
- Mahi Manu Liquid	1810.5	1019	0.2	0.1	6.5	6.2	6.6	6.3	-
- Mirae Asset Liquid	2915.8	10973	0.2	0.1	6.4	6.1	6.5	6.2	-
- Motilal Oswal Liquid	14.6	930	0.4	0.2	6.0	5.8	6.1	5.8	-
- Navi Liquid	30.1	75	0.2	0.2	5.8	5.7	5.8	5.7	-
- Nippon Ind Liquid	6791.2	35870	0.3	0.2	6.6	6.3	6.7	6.3	-
- Parag Parikh Liquid	1542.6	5575	0.2	0.1	6.5	6.2	6.7	6.2	-
- PGIM India Liquid	362.4	748	0.2	0.1	6.5	6.4	6.7	6.3	-
- Quant Liquid	43.8	1255	0.5	0.3	5.6	5.5	5.8	5.7	-
- Quantum Liquid	37.1	531	0.3	0.2	5.9	5.6	5.9	5.7	-
- SBI Liquid	4348.5	71448	0.3	0.2	6.6	6.3	6.7	6.2	-
- Sundaram Liquid	2453.8	6365	0.3	0.1	7.6	6.6	6.7	6.2	-
- Tata Liquid	4382.5	22044	0.3	0.2	6.7	6.2	6.6	6.3	-
- TRUSTMF Liquid	1350.7	756	0.2	0.1	6.4	6.1	6.5	6.1	-
- Union Liquid	2677.9	6650	0.2	0.1	6.5	6.3	6.7	6.3	-
- UTI Liquid	456.6	27632	0.2	0.1	6.5	6.3	6.7	6.3	-
- WhiteOak Capital Liquid	1494.9	640	0.3	0.2	6.4	6.1	6.6	6.1	-

OVERNIGHT FUNDS

- Aditya Birla SL Overnight	1465.9	8574	0.1	0.0	5.1	5.0	5.0	5.2	-
- Axis Overnight	1442.0	8216	0.1	0.1	5.2	5.1	5.1	5.3	-
- Bandhan Overnight	1446.6	1260	0.1	0.0	5.1	5.1	5.0	5.2	-
- Bank of India Overnight	1386.8	43	0.1	0.1	5.2	5.8	5.5	5.6	-
- Baroda BNP Paribas Overnight	1429.6	776	0.1	0.1	5.1	5.1	5.1	5.3	-
- Canara Robeco Overnight	1409.8	304	0.1	0.1	5.2	5.1	5.1	5.3	-
- DSP Overnight	1456.0	3222	0.1	0.1	5.1	5.1	5.1	5.3	-
- Edelweiss Overnight	1409.1	143	0.1	0.1	5.2	5.1	5.1	5.3	-
- Franklin Ind Overnight	1421.6	799	0.1	0.1	5.2	5.2	5.2	5.4	-
- Groww Overnight	1399.2	95	0.2	0.1	5.0	5.0	4.9	5.1	-
- HDFC Overnight	4010.5	9991	0.2	0.1	5.1	5.0	5.0	5.2	-
- HSBC Overnight	1418.7	3644	0.1	0.1	5.1	5.1	5.1	5.3	-
- ICICI Pru Overnight	1464.2	10066	0.1	0.1	5.1	5.1	5.1	5.3	-
- Invesco India Overnight	1376.6	572	0.1	0.1	5.2	5.1	5.1	5.3	-
- ITI Overnight	1373.7	21	0.2	0.1	4.8	4.8	4.8	5.0	-
- JM Overnight	1378.9	81	0.1	0.1	5.0	4.9	4.9	5.1	-
- Kotak Overnight	1449.0	6260	0.2	0.1	5.1	5.1	5.1	5.3	-
- LIC MF Overnight	1405.6	940	0.1	0.1	5.1	5.1	5.1	5.3	-
- Mahi Manu Overnight	1405.2	62	0.2	0.1	5.0	5.0	5.0	5.2	-
- Mirae Asset Overnight	1393.8	1130	0.1	0.1	5.1	5.1	5.1	5.3	-
- Nippon Ind Overnight	145.9	6785	0.1	0.1	5.1	5.1	5.1	5.3	-
- PGIM India Overnight	1403.1	79	0.2	0.1	5.0	5.0	5.0	5.2	-
- SBI Overnight	4385.6	26839	0.1	0.1	5.1	5.1	5.1	5.2	-
- Sundaram Overnight	1441.9	854	0.1	0.1	5.1	5.1	5.0	5.2	-
- Tata Overnight	1431.7	3893	0.2	0.1	5.1	5.1	5.1	5.2	-
- Union Overnight	1429.1	550	0.2	0.1	5.1	5.1	5.1	5.2	-
- UTI Overnight	3700.8	4264	0.1	0.1	5.1	5.1	5.1	5.3	-

ARBITRAGE FUNDS

- Aditya Birla SL Arbitrage	28.2	26646	0.9	0.3	7.6	5.8	6.0	6.0	-
- Axis Arbitrage	19.9	10362	0.9	0.3	7.1	5.5	5.9	5.9	-
- Bandhan Arbitrage	34.4	8190	0.9	0.3	7.0	5.4	5.7	5.7	-
- Bank of India Arbitrage	14.6	48	0.9	0.4	6.0	5.0	5.3	5.5	-
- Baroda BNP Paribas Arbitrage	17.0	1147	1.0	0.3	6.5	5.2	5.5	5.6	-
- DSP Arbitrage	15.9	6529	0.9	0.3	6.9	5.4	5.8	5.8	-
- Edelweiss Arbitrage	20.6	15062	0.9	0.3	7.6	5.8	6.0	6.0	-
- HDFC Arbitrage	32.6	23772	0.8	0.3	7.0	5.8	6.1	6.1	-
- HSBC Arbitrage	20.2	2944	0.8	0.2	7.4	5.6	6.1	6.0	-
- ICICI Pru Arbitrage	36.5	33423	0.8	0.3	7.6	5.7	6.1	6.0	-
- Invesco India Arbitrage	33.9	28526	0.9	0.3	7.3	5.8	6.1	6.1	-
- ITI Arbitrage	13.7	72	0.8	0.2	6.6	4.6	5.7	5.8	-
- JM Arbitrage	34.5	383	0.9	0.4	6.8	5.4	5.5	5.7	-
- Kotak Arbitrage	39.8	72409	1.0	0.4	7.4	5.8	6.2	6.0	-
- LIC MF Arbitrage	14.7	243	0.8	0.3	6.9	6.0	6.1	5.9	-
- Mahi Manu Arbitrage	13.0	126	1.0	0.3	6.4	5.2	5.3	5.4	-
- Mirae Asset Arbitrage	13.8	3737	0.8	0.1	8.0	5.8	5.9	5.9	-
- Nippon Ind Arbitrage	28.2	16638	0.9	0.3	7.2	5.9	6.0	6.0	0.60
- PGIM India Arbitrage	19.5	94	0.9	0.3	6.9	6.0	6.0	5.6	-
- SBI Arbitrage Opport	35.9	45923	0.8	0.4	7.1	5.7	6.0	6.0	-
- Sundaram Arbitrage	15.4	650	0.9	0.2	6.7	6.3	6.3	6.0	-
- Tata Arbitrage	15.3	24026	0.9	0.3	7.1	5.6	5.9	6.0	-
- Union Arbitrage	14.9	246	0.9	0.3	7.3	5.7	5.9	5.8	-
- UTI Arbitrage	37.3	11324	0.7	0.2	6.9	5.6	5.9	6.0	-

DEBT FUNDS

DEBT - ULTRA SHORT DURATION FUNDS

***** Aditya Birla SL Savings	585.3	17816	0.5	0.3	6.2	7.2	7.3	6.4	13.27
***** Baroda BNPP Ultra Short Duration	1645.2	623	0.4	0.2	6.2	6.9	7.0	6.3	-
***** Mirae Asset Ultra Short Duration	1396.7	1467	0.4	0.2	6.3	7.1	7.2	6.3	9.78
***** Bandhan Ultra Short Duration	16.2	4099	0.4	0.2	6.1	6.8	7.0	6.1	-
***** HSBC Ultra Short Duration	1443.9	3621	0.3	0.1	6.2	6.9	7.0	6.2	-
***** ICICI Pru Ultra Short Term	29.5	14352	0.7	0.3	6.2	6.9	7.0	6.2	11.94
***** Nippon Ind Ultra Short Duration	4290.0	10200	0.9	0.3	6.1	6.7	6.8	6.1	24.18
*** Axis Ultra Short Duration	15.6	4949	1.1	0.3	5.7	6.5	6.6	5.8	13.28
*** DSP Ultra Short	3616.2	3905	0.9	0.3	5.7	6.5	6.6	5.8	7.75
*** HDFC Ultra Short Term	16.1	15950	0.6	0.3	5.9	6.7	6.9	6.1	6.38
*** Invesco India Ultra Short Duration	2870.0	1002	0.7	0.2	6.0	6.7	6.9	5.9	0.30
*** Kotak Savings	45.6	14181	0.8	0.4	5.9	6.7	6.8	6.0	7.02
*** Mahi Manu Ultra Short Duration	1464.9	196	0.6	0.3	6.0	6.7	6.9	6.0	1.28
*** SBI Ultra Short Duration	6364.8	11408	0.5	0.3	6.1	6.8	6.9	6.1	9.41
*** Tata Ultra Short Term	15.1	5267	1.0	0.3	5.9	6.5	6.6	5.8	10.46
*** UTI Ultra Short Duration	4502.9	3146	0.8	0.3	5.8	6.6	6.7	6.5	10.48
*** WhiteOak Capital Ultra Short Dur	1443.7	535	1.0	0.5	5.6	6.3	6.4	5.7	-
** BOI Ultra Short Duration	3357.3	148	0.9	0.4	5.8	6.4	6.4	5.7	7.45
** Canara Robeco Ultra Short Term	4031.1	503	0.8	0.3	5.7	6.4	6.4	5.6	-
** LIC MF Ultra Short Duration	1401.4	441	1.2	0.2	5.6	6.3	6.4	5.6	1.15
** PGIM India Ultra Short Duration	36.1	166	0.8	0.3	5.5	6.2	6.4	5.7	3.02
** ITI Ultra Short Term	1309.5	153	1.7	0.2	5.6	6.2	6.3	5.4	-
* Motilal Oswal Ultra Short Term	17.4	378	1.0	0.2	5.1	5.5	5.7	5.0	-
* Sundaram Ultra Short Duration	2833.1	1972	1.2	0.2	5.1	5.8	6.0	5.2	1.58

DEBT - LOW DURATION FUNDS

***** ICICI Pru Savings	581.1	22339	0.5	0.4	6.3	7.3	7.4	6.6	7.85
***** UTI Low Duration	3784.1	2460	0.4	0.3	6.0	7.2	7.2	7.4	7.79
***** Axis Treasury Advantage	3297.1	4650	0.6	0.3	6.0	7.1	7.1	6.3	6.95
***** Bandhan Low Duration	41.0	5986	0.6	0.3	5.7	6.8	6.9	6.0	-
***** HDFC Low Duration	61.3	18242	0.9	0.4	5.6	6.8	6.9	6.1	13.36

bl rating	Scheme Name	Latest NAV (₹)	Latest Corpus (₹ Cr.)	Expense Ratio (%)		Trailing Returns (%)				AA & Below
				Regular	Direct	1 Year CAGR	2 Year CAGR	3 Year CAGR	5 Year CAGR	
*****	HSBC Low Duration	30.5	915	0.8	0.3	5.9	7.5	7.5	6.3	10.77
***	Aditya Birla SL Low Duration	695.5	9775	1.0	0.4	5.4	6.5	6.6	5.9	13.19
***	Canara Robeco Savings	44.9	1101	0.4	0.2	5.8	6.9	7.0	6.1	-
***	DSP Low Duration	21.1	4244	0.5	0.3	5.6	6.8	6.9	6.0	-
***	Invesco India Low Duration	4021.6	1663	0.5	0.3	5.7	6.8	6.9	6.0	4.65
***	JM Low Duration	39.4	219	0.8	0.3	5.7	6.8	6.8	5.9	3.42
***	Mirae Asset Low Duration	2398.9	2085	0.7	0.2	5.6	6.7	6.8	5.9	6.25
***	Nippon Ind Low Duration	3981.3	7379	0.8	0.3	5.8	6.9	6.9	6.1	9.03
***	Tata Treasury Advantage	4185.1	2051	0.5	0.2	5.9	6.9	6.9	6.1	7.13
**	Kotak Low Duration	3547.6	11523	1.2	0.4	5.5	6.7	6.7	5.9	10.97
**	LIC MF Low Duration	42.0	1706	0.4	0.2	5.7	6.6	6.7	5.8	6.10
**	Mahi Manu Low Duration	1735.1	561	0.9	0.3	5.6	6.6	6.7	5.8	13.17
**	SBI Low Duration	3703.7	13394	0.8	0.4	5.4	6.6	6.7	5.9	4.01
*	Baroda BNP Paribas Low Duration	42.5	274	0.9	0.2	5.5	6.5	6.6	5.7	1.83
*	Sundaram Low Duration	3660.5	385	1.0	0.3	5.2	6.5	6.6	5.8	2.51

DEBT - MONEY MARKET FUNDS

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Multiplexes, eateries lace up for FIFA finale

SALES WINDFALL. States allow restaurants and pubs to stay open till early on Monday

Meenakshi Verma Ambwani
New Delhi

As Spain and Argentina lace up for the high-decibel FIFA World Cup finals clash, multiplexes, restaurants and food delivery apps are also gearing up to tackle the consumption uptick that will last till early on Monday.

With some State governments allowing bars, pubs and restaurants to remain open for longer hours in key cities such as Bengaluru, Hyderabad and New Delhi, food brands anticipate a windfall.

FRENZY IN KERALA

Kerala is witnessing unprecedented football frenzy ahead of the final, with massive public screenings, government-backed community viewings, and even school holidays adding to the excitement. Eagles FC has secured large-scale viewing rights across Kerala and is hosting stadium-like screening events at multiple venues.

At the grassroots level, residents’ associations, sports clubs, and local panchayats are organising free, non-commercial screenings at community centres, parish halls, and street corners, turning the World Cup final into a collective celebration across the State. The West Bengal government is also reportedly planning for community screenings.

MORE SCREENS

Leading multiplex chains, which have been screening FIFA matches, expect stronger footfalls for the final match. Ashish Misra, Head of Commercialisation, Cinépolis India, said the company is scaling up operations for the night with additional screens at places where bookings have surged, extra service and security staff and quick-service F&B menu.

“The knockout rounds have really supercharged the turnout for us. Our first semi-final ran at nearly 90 per cent occupancy despite the mid-



GEARED UP. Leading multiplex chains, which have been screening FIFA matches, expect stronger footfalls for the final match NAGARA GOPAL

night kick-off, and the second semi-final was sold out. Heading into an Argentina vs Spain final, we are preparing for unprecedented demand. We are actively evaluating additional screens across our key multiplexes so as many fans as possible can watch the final on the big screen,” he added.

PVR INOX is screening the final match in more than 100 screens across 53 cities. Gautam Dutta, CEO – Revenue and Operations, PVR INOX, said, “The enthusiastic

response to our screenings with strong occupancies reflects the growing demand for premium, collective viewing experiences.”

Restaurateurs, food delivery apps and quick commerce platform are celebrating the unexpected surge in late-night orders since the start of the FIFA World Cup. Muralikrishnan, Co- Founder and CMO, Wow! Momo Foods, said, “We have not seen this kind of football frenzy as we are seeing for the ongoing

FIFA World Cup. The late-night consumption occasion is contributing as much as 25-26 per cent of our business. In line with these trends, we expect to see a 48-50 per cent kind of jump in transactions through aggregators and self-delivery channel this Sunday,” He added that FIFA has also provided a consumption boost for the brand in terms of same store sales growth. Several eateries are hoping to welcome a higher number of guests after authorities in some cities gave them the nod to run their operations till early hours of Monday. Divya Aggarwal, Chief Growth Officer at Impresario Entertainment & Hospitality Pvt. Ltd, which runs SOCIAL, said, “With the final approaching, there is a great deal of excitement among fans, and we expect a 5–10 per cent increase in guests gathering across select outlets.”

(With inputs from V. Sajeev Kumar, Kochi)

Push limits, build for world: FM to Young Indians

Our Bureau
Chennai

Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman on Saturday urged young entrepreneurs to shed the hesitation to taking risks and told them that technology and India’s improving business ecosystem have created opportunities for businesses to scale globally.

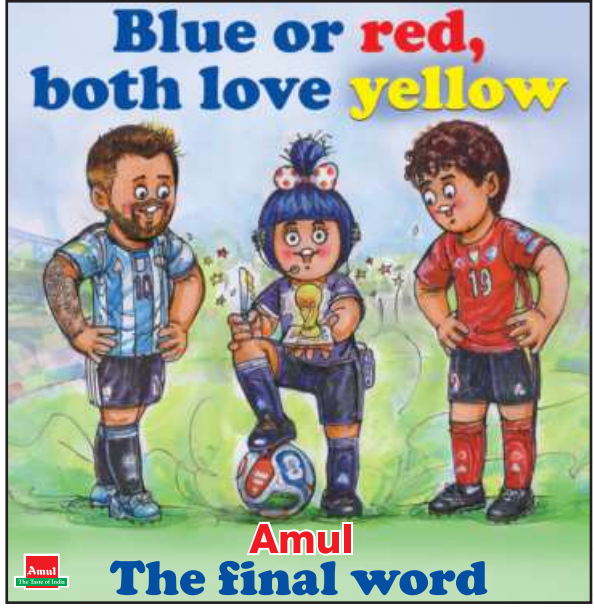
“Build boldly, build responsibly, build for India, build for the world and build for generations to come,” the Finance Minister said, speaking at YiFi 2026, a flagship national entrepreneurship summit of CII’s Young Indians (Yi), hosted by Madurai this year. The summit theme was ‘Entrepreneurship Beyond Boundaries’.

“The boundaries that remain are often those we impose on ourselves... Entrepreneurship beyond boundaries is entrepreneurship beyond your own hesitation,” she said, adding that fear of failure can no longer be justified.

Sitharaman said India remained the world’s fastest-growing major economy despite geopolitical disruptions, including conflicts in Ukraine and West Asia, supply-chain challenges and commodity price volatility.

P Ravichandran, Chairman, CII Southern Region and President, Danfoss India, said the government and the FM had kept homes and farms safe by safeguarding the 3 Fs — fuel, fertilizers and foreign exchange — during the West Asia crisis.

Chandrajit Banerjee, Director-General, CII, said that CII and Yi are working together to create platforms that connect young people with policymakers and industry, fostering greater collaboration and participation in nation-building.



2024 National Awards: ‘Article 370’ named best film; Mammooty, Kartik Aaryan, Yami Gautam best actors

Our Bureau
New Delhi

Hindi film *Article 370* was named the Best Feature Film of the 72nd National Film Awards for 2024. The awards were announced on Saturday.

Malayalam superstar Mammooty for *Bramayugam* and Kartik Aaryan for Hindi film *Chandu Champion* shared the Best Actor in a Leading Role award. Yami Gautam was declared the Best Actress in a Leading Role award for *Article 370*.

Randeep Hooda won the Best Debut Director award for *Swatantrya Veer Savarkar*.

The blockbuster movie, *Kalki 2898 AD* bagged awards for Best Popular Film Providing Wholesome Entertainment and Best Production Design categories.

Rajkumar Periasamy won the Best Director award for Tamil film *Amaran*, which

also won the Best Editing award and shared the Best Music Direction award with *Article 370*.

Pushpa: The Rule Part-02 won the Best Costume Design award and shared the Best Screenplay award with Marathi film *Swargandharva Sudhir Phadke* and Telugu flick *Lucky Baskhar*.

Tamil flick *Captain Miller* was named the Best Feature Film Promoting National, Social and Environmental Values while Telugu flick *Chinna Katha Kaadu* bagged the Best Children’s Film Award.

Bhangaar won the award for best non-feature film, while *Ram-Nami* was named the Best Documentary.

Raayan was named as the best Tamil film, *Mithya* as the best Kannada film, *Committee Kurrollu* was named the best Telugu film and *Femini-chi Fathima* the best Malayalam film in the language categories.

Vikram-1 takes India’s private space sector to new orbit

Rohan Das
Chennai

Even erratic weather conditions and last minute technical snags could not keep Skyroot Aerospace’s Vikram-1 grounded for long, as the space vehicle surged into the Saturday afternoon sky to become the first Indian privately-built launch vehicle to achieve full orbital flight. With this, India has become only the third country with a private orbital class launch vehicle capability.

The seven-storey-tall rocket, built by Hyderabad-based space tech start-up Skyroot, lifted off from the

first launch pad at Satish Dhawan Space Centre in Sriharikota. The command centre presented a very different sight than usual launches with a group of youngsters in their 20s and 30s nervously peering over their consoles.

SLIGHT DELAY

Some nervous moments due to minor software issues led to a 35-minute delay in launch time, but it was complete elation at 12.05 p.m. as Vikram-1 lifted-off successfully.

Titled ‘*Aagaman*’, or arrival, the mission captured the real-time in-flight performance data from every

system on Vikram-1 — propulsion, stage separation, guidance, navigation, control, and overall vehicle performance. After liftoff, the mission unfolded in three stages. The first two flew by in under two minutes as the rocket powered through the lower atmosphere and entered space where it shed its protective fairings. The third stage was slower and more precise, providing the final push towards orbit before the Orbital Adjustment Module in six tense minutes placed the payload into its intended orbit.

While the key objective of the launch was to validate systems in Vikram-1, the

rocket also carried some technology demonstration payloads from companies like Grahaa Space, CosmoServe, and DCubed, which were inserted into the Low Earth Orbit.

SMALL TALISMAN

Interestingly, also on board was a lab-grown diamond from Cosmos Diamonds’, a micro-art piece of some of India’s space legends including Vikram Sarabhai, APJ Abdul Kalam and CV Raman and letters from well wishers including PM Narendra Modi.

Speaking at the post launch press conference, Pawan Kumar Chandana,

ICICI Bank net up 16% on higher NII, lower provisions

Our Bureau
Mumbai

ICICI Bank reported a healthy 16 per cent year-on-year (y-o-y) increase in standalone net profit for the first quarter of FY27 to ₹14,805 crore, supported by growth in both net interest income (NII) and non-interest income, along with a decline in provisions.

India’s second-largest private sector bank posted a net profit of ₹12,768 crore in Q1 last year.

To a question on whether the net interest margin (NIM) of 4.36 per cent in Q1FY27 (4.34 per cent in Q1FY26) is sustainable,

Q1 performance (in ₹ cr)			
	Q1FY26	Q1FY27	y-o-y % change
Net profit	12,768	14,805	16.0
Net interest income	21,635	24,384	12.7
Non-interest income	7,264	8,425	16.0
Operating profit	18,746	20,386	8.7
Provisions	1,815	1,260	-30.6
Deposits	16,08,517	18,33,586	14.0
Advances	13,64,157	16,31,260	19.6
GNPA %	1.67	1.38	-
NNPA %	0.41	0.35	-

Sandeep Batra, Executive Director, ICICI Bank, said: “This quarter, we benefited from income tax refunds, which helped in margin improvement. The margins in Q1 also reflect the benefits of term deposits repricing and

higher interest refunds, partially offset by higher interest reversals of Kisan Credit Card portfolio,” he added.

On mobilisation of fresh FCNR(B) deposits under the RBI’s concessional swap window, he said the bank would

offer leverage based on customer profiles and the extent of leverage available through its partners. ICICI Bank will also raise bonds overseas to provide leverage to NRIs.

During the quarter, NII rose 13 per cent y-o-y to ₹24,384 crore from ₹21,635 crore a year earlier. Total non-interest income, comprising fee income, dividend income from subsidiaries and other income, increased 16 per cent y-o-y to ₹8,425 crore. Treasury income, however, plummeted 88 per cent to ₹151 crore.

Provisions, including towards non-performing assets and standard assets, fell 31 per cent to ₹1,260 crore (₹1,815 crore).

Lower provisions, recoveries boost Axis, Kotak & IDBI Q1 profit; YES Bank posts strong growth

Akshata Gorde
Suresh P Iyengar
Mumbai

Lower provisioning and strong recoveries helped Axis Bank, Kotak Mahindra Bank and IDBI Bank post healthy profit growth in the June, or the first, quarter of FY27, while YES Bank delivered a strong performance driven by the strength of its core earnings engine.

Axis Bank reported a better-than-expected Q1, with the net profit rising 22.5 per cent year-on-year to ₹7,114 crore. The growth was aided by a sharp 44 per cent decline in provisions to ₹2,223 crore, while the net interest income (NII) rose 8 per cent to ₹14,646 crore on the back of healthy loan growth across corporate, SME and retail segments. The bank maintained stable asset quality and retained its ₹2,001-crore precautionary provision for West Asia-related risks.

“We continue to deliver quality growth while strengthening our balance-sheet and maintaining a disciplined risk framework. We believe the June quarter marks the cycle bottom for margins,” said Amitabh Chaudhry, MD and CEO.

Mixed bag				
	Axis Bank	Kotak Bank	IDBI bank*	YES bank
Net profit	22.5	25.6	5.4	33.7
Net interest income (NII)	8.0	9.2	10.1	17.5
Non-interest income	-7.2	8.4	-28.2	2.6
Operating profit	1.3	10.2	-7.9	25.5
Provisions	-43.7	-44.7	254.9	38.9
Net interest margin (NIM)*	3.5	4.5	2.7	3.6
Total deposit	18.2	11.7	9.8	14.3
Advances	19.1	15.0	22.2	18.3
GNPA%	1.3	1.4	2.3	1.3
NNPA%	0.4	0.3	0.2	0.2

*In IDBI Bank case provision is recovery of ₹637 crore, boosted the bottomline
#NIM are down for Axis Bank (34 bps), Kotak (12 bps) & IDBI Bank (7 bps), while YES Bank it improved by 20 bps

Kotak Mahindra Bank, too, reported a 26 per cent increase in net profit to ₹4,123 crore, its strongest earnings growth in two years. A 45 per cent decline in provisions to ₹668 crore supported profitability, while the NII grew 9.2 per cent to ₹7,928 crore. Deposits rose 11.7 per cent and advances grew 15 per cent, led by corporate and SME lending. Asset quality remained stable, with gross NPA improving to 1.38 per cent and net NPA at 0.27 per cent.

“...we have prioritised stability, profitability and efficiency without any com-

promise to our overarching strategy around the four focus customer segments,” said Ashok Vaswani, Managing Director and CEO.

IDBI Bank, on the other hand, posted a 5.4 per cent rise in net profit to ₹2,115 crore, aided by strong recoveries from stressed and written-off accounts. Net recovery and write-backs surged to ₹637 crore from ₹179 crore a year earlier. NII increased 10.1 per cent to ₹3,486 crore, while advances grew 22.2 per cent and deposits rose 9.8 per cent. Net NPA improved to 0.16 per cent.

YES Bank, in contrast, saw profit grow, driven by improving core operating performance rather than lower provisioning. Net profit rose 34 per cent to ₹1,071 crore, supported by a 17.5 per cent increase in the NII to ₹2,786 crore. Advances rose 18.3 per cent to ₹2.85 lakh crore and deposits grew 14.3 per cent to ₹3.15 lakh crore, while gross NPA improved to 1.3 per cent.

“Our net profit grew even as some of our non-core income streams moderated, a clear sign that our core recurring earnings engine is increasingly driving performance,” said Vinay Tonse, Managing Director and CEO.

On **FCNR(B) deposits**, private sector banks reported encouraging interest from NRIs but refrained from providing estimates before September-end.

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